



Impact Evaluation Findings of STiR Education's Programme in Uganda

Year 1 Evaluation Report
July 2020



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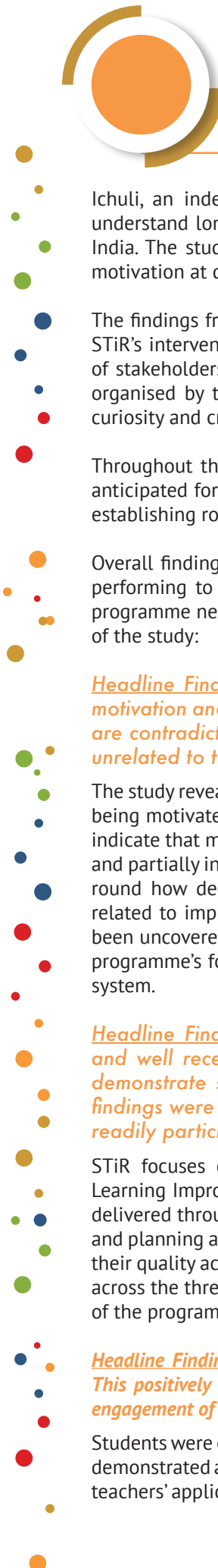
Acronyms

ASSHU	Association of Secondary School Headteachers Uganda
CPD	Continuous Professional Development
DEL	District Education Leaders
DEO	District Education Officer
DIS	District Inspector of Schools
ELM	Education Leader Manager (includes CCTs, UNATU and ASSHU Representatives)
HT	Head Teacher
LIG	Learning Improvement Group (includes DEO, DIS, MEO, MIS)
MEO	Municipal Education Officer
MIS	Municipal Inspector of Schools
MoES	Ministry of Education and Sports
SDI	Service Delivery Indicators
SEL	School Education Leaders
UNATU	Uganda National Teachers' Union

Acknowledgements

STiR's programme in Uganda is led by a team of highly passionate professionals who work tirelessly to coach and support government officials across the country. About a year and a half ago from the time that the study started, the Ministry of Education and Sports in Uganda and STiR collaboratively decided to move toward a system-led approach, through which all schools in a district would become part of the programme. This meant a significant change in terms of how STiR's programme team supports their districts, from being focused on direct implementation toward energising and coaching government officials at different levels of the system to role model the foundations of lifelong learning. This was a daunting task, and required STiR's programme team to be compassionate, entrepreneurial, and resilient. The findings in this report indicate initial signs that STiR's partnership with the Ministry of Education and Sports as part of the system-led approach can play an important role in creating a sense of shared purpose to support teachers and ultimately student learning. We'd like to acknowledge particularly the hard work among STiR's programme leads who were leading the work in the study districts when data collection took place: Angella Bulamu, Betty Ongwen, Doris Nabugasha, and Janat Namatovu, among all the rest of STiR's programme team who are leading similar efforts across Uganda.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Ichuli, an independent research organisation headquartered in Uganda, was commissioned by STiR Education to understand longitudinal trends and impacts from their programme over 4 years in eastern Uganda and two states in India. The study's objective is to test STiR's 5-year change hypothesis to understand how improvements in intrinsic motivation at different levels of the education system contribute to improved teaching practices and student learning.

The findings from Year 1 of the study are presented in this report to provide a lens on the progress made by Year 2 of STiR's intervention in Uganda. Results present linkages and outcomes between the data collected across three levels of stakeholders in the education system – students, teachers and head teachers, and education officials. Findings are organised by the key measurement areas STiR uses to evaluate behaviour change: engagement, safety, self-esteem, curiosity and critical thinking, and learning time and intentional teaching.

Throughout the report, findings from Year 1 of the longitudinal study are compared against the achievements STiR anticipated for each indicator by the completion of Year 2 of their progress pathway, which expects stakeholders to be establishing routines which they will later be expected to strengthen and improve during Years 3-5 of the programme.

Overall findings from the first year of the study were positive and illuminated where the programme is on track and performing to expectation according to Year 2 of STiR's progress pathway metrics as well as which aspects of the programme need improvement in the coming years. The following findings were identified as key learnings from Year 1 of the study:

Headline Finding 1: Positively, teachers, head teachers and education officials report high levels of intrinsic motivation and satisfaction with their participation in the STiR programme. However, these self-reported attitudes are contradicted by high rates of absenteeism from work and at least 20% of overall daily time spent on tasks unrelated to teaching and learning.

The study revealed that while teachers, head teachers and education officials self-reported feeling motivated at work and being motivated by the STiR programme, their frequent absences and time off task throughout their working days may indicate that motivation may not be as high as reported and the factors that influence motivation are likely complicated and partially influenced by structural and extrinsic forces. It is not yet clear from the data collected in this first evaluation round how deep self-reported motivation goes and whether it is helping to influence and improve core practices related to improving teaching and learning. However, lost teaching and learning time in public Ugandan schools has been uncovered by other similar studies and represents a danger point which has the potential to undermine the STiR programme's focus on building foundations of lifelong learning among students and within all levels of the education system.

Headline Finding 2: Independent observations of STiR's programme activities indicate they are high-quality and well received by stakeholders, who actively engage in institutes, reflection and network meetings, and demonstrate significant levels of autonomy, mastery and purpose in their delivery of these activities. These findings were corroborated by teachers, head teachers and education officials who reported appreciating and readily participating in STiR activities to grow their skills and capacities.

STiR focuses on role-modelling and developing positive relationships amongst education system actors through Learning Improvement Cycles (LICs), which promote peer-to-peer linkages and provide learning opportunities. LICs are delivered through in-school network meetings for teachers, training institutes for head teachers and education officials, and planning and reflection meetings for district education actors. Ichuli enumerators attended STiR activities to observe their quality according to rubrics developed by STiR. Findings showed that activity quality was very high in study districts across the three pillars, were appreciated by participants and primarily met STiR's progress pathway ambition for Year 2 of the programme.

Headline Finding 3: Students report liking school and are observed actively and readily engaging in classroom activities. This positively links to the observed actions of teachers in the classroom, notably regarding student praise and the equal engagement of boys and girls in lesson activities.

Students were observed actively participating in classroom activities and showed engagement with their teacher. Teachers demonstrated a good rapport with students and generally included all students in the classroom, suggesting a link between teachers' application of inclusive teaching practices, student engagement and student enjoyment of school and learning.

However, students also reported being frequently absent and attendance data taken on the day of the study helped to confirm this. While student absenteeism can be influenced by several factors – many of which may be outside of a students' control, such as illness or family commitments – time out of class can lead to disengagement from learning and affect overall motivation and educational gains.

Headline Finding 4: *Routine observations of teachers and head teachers by education officials is positively related to reports of head teachers frequently observing their own teachers, and teachers reporting that they are regularly observed by their superiors. Direct, corresponding connections across this chain of stakeholders is a positive sign that observation processes are streamlined under the programme and highly prioritised by education actors.*

Most teachers reported being regularly observed by their head teacher or another school management actor. Observation and feedback loops between officials, head teachers and teachers are a critical part of the process to strengthen the instructional and administrative capacities of school actors; however, some progress is needed to ensure all secondary teachers are being observed regularly by their head teacher. Overall, the consistency in observation visits reported across all education actors in the programme is encouraging and should be built upon going forward.

Headline Finding 5: *Teachers and head teachers reported receiving useful feedback from observations. However, teachers, head teachers and education officials admitted that the coaching provided during feedback sessions was primarily positive and focused on offering praise, rather than constructive advice to improve instructional practice. Despite this, teachers and head teachers reported that they are inspired by receiving praise and recognition from their superiors and consider it a critical driver of their intrinsic motivation.*

Teachers and head teachers overwhelmingly reported that the coaching and feedback provided to them by education officials was useful, however they and education officials also reported that feedback was mostly positive and focused on praise rather than constructive feedback to help them improve. Consistent observation and coaching is aligned to STiR's progress pathway ambition of establishing routines in Year 2, but it should be geared more towards targeted, specific and corrective feedback during Year 3-5 moving forward.

Headline Finding 6: *Teachers overwhelmingly reported applying the instructional methods introduced by STiR and trying them in their classrooms, which aligns with observations of student engagement during lessons and teacher use of LIC themes in class. Teachers accurately described how they apply methods related to creating a positive learning environment, using learning aids, providing praise, checking for understanding and spacing practice to engage their learners. However, they were not as adept at correctly explaining how they promote a growth mind-set in their students, use effective and elaborative questioning techniques, or integrate retrieval practice in their lessons.*

Teachers consistently reported trying out the teaching and learning practices they learn from network meetings and the majority felt there was a positive change in their classroom teaching practices since they started using STiR's LIC themes. Teachers demonstrated high levels of understanding with several LIC themes, but some improvement is needed to ensure they are using best practice while teaching other LIC themes. Overall, findings positively indicate that teachers are consistently trying out new teaching strategies, which is a strong sign of their confidence and motivation, and in line with STiR's progress pathway ambition for establishing routines in Year 2. But, additional effort is needed between Year 3 and Year 5 to ensure teachers' confidence to try out new teaching strategies is also complemented by good practice.

Headline Finding 7: *Teachers reported that they are regularly observed by their peers and that feedback from these visits helps them to improve their practice. Unlike the coaching and feedback provided by head teachers and education officials, which is primarily focused on praise, peer-to-peer learning within the programme appears to be highly appreciated by teachers and provides a stronger basis for constructive support.*

Teachers reported receiving feedback from their peers on their teaching and that the feedback was useful, especially because it helps them identify their strengths and weaknesses and improve their teaching. These findings suggest that peer-to-peer mentorship under the STiR programme, especially in primary schools, is frequent and provides teachers with constructive inputs to help them grow as educators. This is significant, as creating a basis for continuous professional development within a school environment, rather than only from external support mechanisms, is critical to growing the skills of teachers and creating a culture of professionalism with colleagues.

Headline Finding 8: *Teacher time on task in the classroom is high and devoted to relevant, subject-related teaching and learning activities. But, most class activities are teacher-led and primarily involve whole group work. This corresponds to observed limitations in teachers' ability to develop the critical and creative thinking abilities of their students during lessons, despite their demonstrated ability to deliver relevant content and information through lecture-based learning techniques.*

Teachers were observed in their classrooms to determine how they spend their time while teaching. Findings indicate that teachers were on-task almost 94% of the time, indicating that when teachers are in the classroom they demonstrate positive behaviours towards instruction and engage in relevant teaching and learning actions. However, a significant amount of class time is spent with learners as a whole group engaged in 'teacher talk time', leaving little time for students to work together or independently engaged in critical and creative thinking skills.

Headline Finding 9: Teachers self-reported and were observed being welcoming and friendly towards students and calling on them by name. This corresponds to students reporting liking school and feeling safe in their academic environment. But, conversely, both teachers and students reported that corporal punishment is a common method of discipline, indicating a disconnect between purported feelings of safety at school and normalized physical punishment practices.

Students reported feeling safe at school but the high rate of corporal punishment and verbal punishment indicate that schools likely do not actually create a safe and positive environment conducive to the foundations of lifelong learning. Although students do not seem to link feeling unsafe with physical punishment, it is important to attempt to change deep seated cultural and social beliefs about safety and punishment so students can learn in an environment that supports their physical and emotional health. Going forward, it is important to involve education stakeholders and students in targeted activities to promote positive discipline and improve the safety and emotional well-being of all learners.

Headline Finding 10: Students reported high levels of determination and grit related to their academic learning. This is connected to observations of teachers encouraging students to set goals, providing them with corrective and specific feedback during lessons, acknowledging their efforts, and having a positive attitude towards helping students address their learning challenges.

Students reported high levels of grit and determination when faced with difficult academic assignments and both students and teachers reported that teachers help students when they are struggling. Classroom observations also indicated that teachers encourage their students, frequently acknowledge their efforts and positively respond to their challenges, indicating that students' grit and determination is met with support from their teachers and likely helps to increase students' confidence and self-esteem – one of the foundations of lifelong learning.

REFLECTIONS AND CONCLUSIONS

Reflections on the measurement approaches used in Year 1 of the study are also presented after the headline findings. These findings revolve around measuring safety and punishment; measuring intrinsic motivation; measuring teacher performance; and measuring the quality of STiR activities. Highlighted findings include 1) the need to find alternative metrics to measure safety in the classroom and school environment during future evaluation points to assess progress on STiR's indicators related to physically and emotionally safe learning environments; 2) the need to take extrinsic motivation factors such as low salaries and lack of benefits into account when considering stakeholders' absenteeism and time off task, possibly by working with local and national education officials as well as school leaders to confront these issues and find ways – through the system – to address factors related to extrinsic motivation and unauthorised and unnecessary absenteeism; and 3) improvements needed in some measurement tools including the classroom observation tool and the STiR activity rubrics, and to ensure that enumerators are all well-trained on each tool to ensure objective, reliable measurement.

The evaluation has shown that driving impact through intrinsic motivation is a process. Teachers and education officials expressed positivity towards the STiR programme and reported high levels of self-reported motivation and professional gain from their involvement. These self-reported indicators are an important measure of personal opinions on motivation, and they show successful results at this stage of the journey. However, motivation must also be measured using externally verifiable behaviours and proxy measures, such as attendance and commitment to completing daily roles and programme activities. Currently, these measures show that motivational drive still needs to be improved across the education system for the intervention to be successful in embedding and sustaining motivation in stakeholders by the end of the five-year support cycle.

The evaluation also found that the concepts of mentoring, role modelling and trying out new practices are beginning to happen with some regularity – key to this year's focus of helping key stakeholders establish routines. But, the evaluation found that these practices currently often lack substance and depth. Additional efforts are needed to ensure that stakeholders are critically engaging within these processes and practices through deeper reflection on practice and driving school and system improvements in order to drive lifelong learning.

Overall, the findings from Year 1 of the study demonstrated that STiR's programme met its targets as outlined for Year 2 of the progress pathway. All findings showed that stakeholders within the education system have established routines within each of the foundations of lifelong learning, the overarching achievement expected by the end of Year 2. Now that routines among stakeholders have been established, STiR must strive to ensure that Year 3 of the programme continues well along the progress pathway and strengthens a culture of improvement among all stakeholders.

1 PROGRAMME AND LONGITUDINAL STUDY OVERVIEW

STiR partners with Dr Rebecca Thornton, Associate Professor of Economics at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign and Ichuli Institute, an independent research organisation headquartered in Uganda and led by Victoria Brown, to understand longitudinal trends and impacts from the programme over 4 years in India and Uganda. The study takes place in eastern Uganda and the states of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu in India. The study's objective is to test STiR's 5-year change hypothesis to understand how improvements in intrinsic motivation at different levels of the education system contribute to improved teaching practices and student learning. The overarching question of the longitudinal study is:

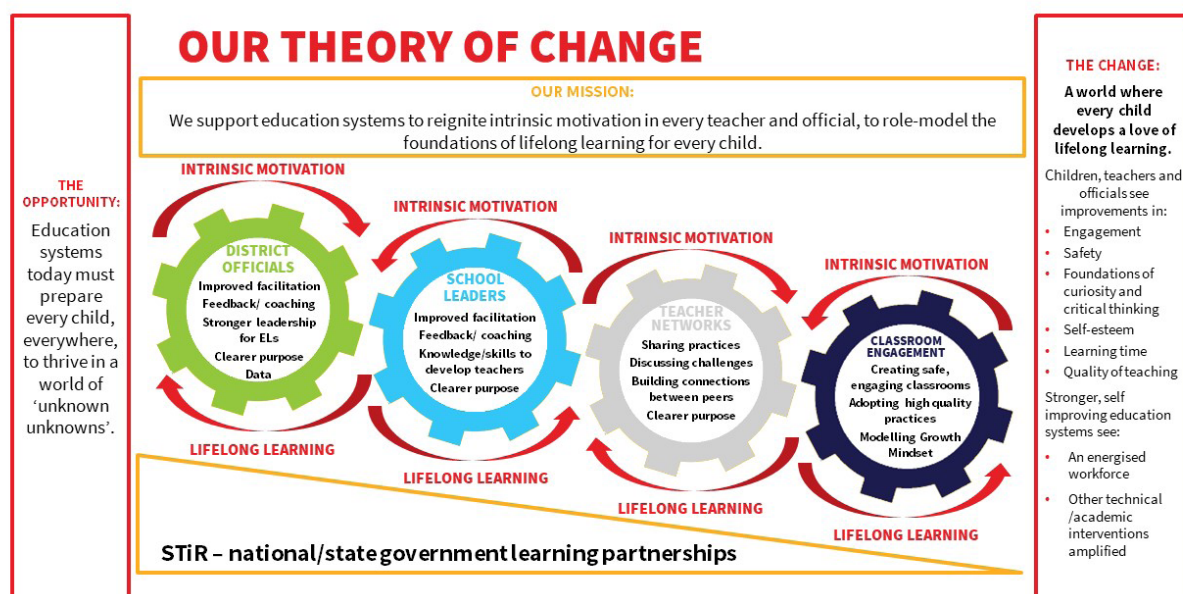


How does STiR's approach, focused on strengthening intrinsic motivation, contribute to sustained improvements in the foundations of lifelong learning among education officials, teachers, and students?

In line with the programme's theory of change, the study explores results against three impact pathways STiR focuses on to reignite intrinsic motivation: 1) behaviour change among officials, teachers, and students through role-modelling; 2) strengthening of the education system; and 3) amplification of other programme technical interventions.

STiR understands role-modelling to be the demonstration and promotion of behaviours and attitudes one wishes to see in others. There is extensive evidence that the most powerful agent in the workplace for an individual is their direct line manager. STiR supports state and district officials, and indirectly teachers, to understand their role in creating the right conditions for those they work with. STiR believes that this focus on role-modelling and relationships is overlooked in most education systems, and they have learned that promoting these in systems is their biggest organisational strength and source of success

Figure 1: STiR's Theory of Change



The initial phase of the study was implemented in 2019. A total of 103 primary and 20 secondary schools were representatively sampled across five districts in eastern Uganda to participate in the evaluation. Head teachers and primary 3, 4 and 7 teachers and students in primary schools and senior 1, 4 and 6 teachers and students in secondary schools were selected to take part in data collection, as well as teacher trainers (coordinating centre tutors – CCTs), district education officials and district inspectors assigned to each district.

Tools for the study were developed in consultation with the STiR team. At the school level tools included teacher, head teacher and learner questionnaires; classroom observation and teacher time on task tools; a shadowing tool to track daily activities and actions on the part of head teachers and teachers; and a school climate survey. At the education official level, tools included education official questionnaires and a shadowing tool to track the daily activities and actions of local officials. STiR's internal monitoring rubrics for network meetings and institutes were utilised for observing programme activities, coupled with self-administered questionnaires and focus group discussions with participants.

2 REPORT STRUCTURE



The findings from Year 1 of the study are presented in this report. Results are grouped according to headline findings which present linkages and outcomes between the data collected across three levels of stakeholders in the education system – students, teachers and head teachers, and education officials. Headline findings are organised by the key measurement areas STiR's uses to evaluate behaviour change in education officials, teachers and students: engagement, safety, self-esteem, curiosity and critical thinking, and learning time and intentional teaching. A selection of tables and graphs are included to demonstrate results for each headline finding; additional data is presented in the Annex.

The report also includes findings from STiR's internal monitoring data, which is compared to externally validated data from the study against the key performance indicators outlined in STiR's progress pathway (shown in Table 1 below). Finally, a short reflection on learnings regarding measurement tools and approaches as well as conclusions from Year 1 of the study in Uganda is presented.



Table 1: STiR's 5-Year Progress Pathway Indicators

STAKEHOLDER / LEVEL	INDICATOR	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3	YEAR 4	YEAR 5
DISTRICT OFFICIALS	% expected district alignment meetings taking place	60 - 80	70 - 90	80 - 100	90 - 100	90 - 100
	District alignment meeting quality (DL scores)	2 to 3	2 to 3	3 to 4	3 to 4	4 to 5
	% expected DL/ELM coaching meetings taking place	50 - 70	60 - 80	70 - 90	80 - 100	90 - 100
	DL/ELM coaching meetings quality (DL scores)	2 to 3	2 to 3	3 to 4	3 to 4	4 to 5
	% expected EL institutes taking place	70 - 90	70 - 90	80 - 90	85 - 100	90 - 100
	% EL institute attendance	60 - 80	70 - 90	80 - 90	85 - 100	85 - 100
	EL institutes quality (DL scores)	1 to 2	2 to 3	2 to 3	3 to 4	4 to 5
	% expected network meetings taking place	50 - 70	60 - 80	70 - 90	80 - 100	85 - 100
	Network meeting quality (DL scores)	1 to 2	2 to 3	2 to 3	3 to 4	4 to 5
TEACHERS	% teachers present at time of observation	40 - 60	50 - 70	60 - 80	70 - 90	80 - 100
	% teachers observed who are trying out new practices	30 - 50	40 - 60	50 - 70	60 - 80	80 - 90
	% of features that show professional development observed in teachers	10 - 30	25 - 50	40 - 60	50 - 70	60 - 80
CHILDREN	% of features that show engagement in learning observed in children	10 - 30	25 - 50	35 - 55	50 - 70	60 - 80
	% of features that show trust in teachers observed in children	10 - 30	25 - 50	35 - 55	50 - 70	60 - 80
	% of features that show a physically and emotionally safe environment observed in children	15 - 35	30 - 50	40 - 60	55 - 75	70 - 90

3 PROGRAMME MONITORING DATA



The figures in the tables below present findings from the longitudinal study in comparison with STiR's internal monitoring data against the achievements STiR anticipated for each indicator by the completion of Year 2 of their progress pathway, which aligns to the first year of the evaluation in Uganda. STiR adopted a 'traffic light' system to measure indicator progress: a green colour in the 'Progress Pathway Ambition' column indicates the indicator is at or above expectation; a yellow colour shows that progress is happening, but caution is needed to ensure progress continues; and a red colour shows that the indicator has not been adequately achieved according to expectation. Overall, the longitudinal study's findings positively align with STiR's results. Most indicators are either on track or exceed expectations for developing a shared purpose among stakeholders and changing mind sets (in Year 1) and establishing routines (in Year 2).

Table 2: High Level Findings about Education Officials Compared to STiR Progress Pathway Ambitions

Indicator	Longitudinal Study Finding	Progress Pathway Ambition
Network meeting quality (out of 5)	3	2-3
Education leader institute quality (out of 5)	3	2-3
Coaching call quality (out of 5)	3	2-3
Mid term meeting quality (out of 5)	4	2-3
% of head teachers who received coaching and support from their Education leader Manager	77%	60-80
% of education leaders who engaged in addition training	70%	N/A
% of teachers being observed	57%	N/A
% of teachers being provided with feedback after observation	52%	N/A

Table 3: High Level Findings about Teachers/HTs Compared to STiR Progress Pathway Ambitions

Indicator	Longitudinal Study Finding	Progress Pathway Ambition
% of teachers in class at time of observation	85% (yet teachers reported missing 0.7 days of school in the past week)	50-70%
% of teachers trying out new practices	75%	40-60%
% of teachers calling on students in class equally	78%	N/A
% of teachers calling on students by name	44%	N/A
% of teachers providing praise to students equally	50%	N/A
% of teachers pursuing additional training opportunities	69%	25-50%

Table 4: High Level Findings about Students Compared to STiR Progress Pathway Ambitions

Indicator	Longitudinal Study Finding	Progress Pathway Ambition
% of students engaged in learning (e.g participate in class activities)	70%	25-50%
% of students who trust their teacher (e.g teacher smiles, warm body language)	46%	25-50%
% of students who follow class rules	66%	25-50%
% of students who know what's expected from them	69%	25-50%
% of students asking their teachers for help	12%	25-50%
% of students who received help with their homework from the teacher	75%	N/A
% of students who learn in a physically safe environment	89%	30-50%
% of students who learn in an emotionally safe environment	67%	30-50%

4 HEADLINE FINDINGS



4.1. INTRINSIC MOTIVATION

Headline Finding 1

Positively, teachers, head teachers and education officials report high levels of intrinsic motivation and satisfaction with their participation in the STiR programme. However, these self-reported attitudes are contradicted by high rates of absenteeism from work and at least 20% of overall daily time spent on tasks unrelated to teaching and learning.

The STiR programme's main goal is to ignite motivation within teachers, head teachers and education officials¹ to positively impact the foundations of lifelong learning among officials, teachers and students. Intrinsic motivation of education stakeholders is measured by demonstrated improvements in Autonomy, Mastery and Purpose, commitment to their roles and responsibilities; and engagement and participation in STiR programme activities.

Teachers, head teachers and officials self-reported extremely high levels of motivation in their daily work and while participating in STiR programme activities. Their positive attitudes and behaviours indicate elevated levels of morale and enjoyment in their daily work as educators and high levels of self-efficacy. Findings did not vary significantly across primary or secondary schools or between genders.

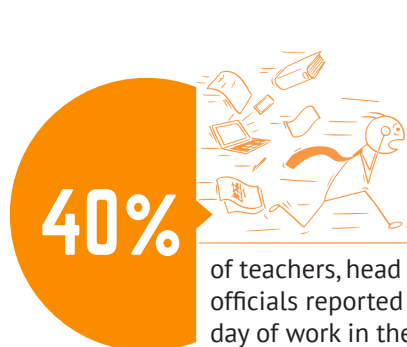
Table 5: Teacher and Head Teacher Self-Reported Motivation

How motivated do you feel at work on most days?	Teacher					Head Teacher				
	Highly motivated	Motivated	Somewhat motivated	Not at all	Not sure	Highly motivated	Motivated	Somewhat motivated	Not at all	Not sure
All schools	12.28%	45.51%	32.63%	3.59%	5.99%	20.37%	59.26%	17.59%	0.93%	1.85%
Primary	12.32%	45.07%	31.69%	3.87%	7.04%	23.08%	56.04%	17.58%	1.10%	2.20%
Secondary	12.0%	48.0%	38.0%	2.0%	0%	5.88%	76.47%	17.65%	0%	0%
Males	9.38%	48.44%	33.85%	3.65%	4.69%	19.35%	64.52%	12.90%	0%	3.23%
Females	16.20%	41.55%	30.99%	3.52%	7.75%	21.74%	52.17%	23.91%	2.17%	0%

However, despite these strong self-reported attitudes, about 40% of teachers, head teachers and local officials reported missing at least one day of work in the past two weeks. Reported absences were somewhat lower among secondary school teachers and head teachers at 30%. Frequent teacher absences were also confirmed by students. Most common reasons given for teacher absence included sickness, personal issues and bereavement. Findings about teacher time on task from classroom observations were also positive, demonstrating that teachers spent 94% of their time on active, instruction-related activities when in the classroom. But, overall, teachers also spent about 20% of their entire day doing activities unrelated to teaching and learning, including personal tasks and extended breaks and transitions between activities. Although it is expected that teachers will spend time having lunch, taking scheduled breaks and transitioning between activities, these extended transitions and personal activities/breaks cannot be accounted for in a school's tight timetable where there are only a few minutes between classes and regimented times for one morning break and one lunch break, meaning that teachers are not in class and teaching for as much of the day as they should be. The World Bank SDI study found a similar problem in Uganda and estimated that public school teachers taught, on average, only 2 hours and 55 minutes each day due to absences or skipping class when in school; a loss of 60% of teaching time². The study found that over a 7-year primary cycle, this lost learning time meant students only actually received about 2.5 years of education. When considered in a similar way, the 20% of each day that STiR teachers lose equates to nearly one full day of lost time per week. This, coupled with teachers missing at least one day of work every two weeks, quickly compounds and results in a lot of lost teaching and learning time and certainly has an effect on the foundations of lifelong learning among students. Head teachers and education officials also spend between 21%-38% of their daily time on non-work related activities, suggesting that there may be a role-modelling effect at play whereby a teacher's superiors also often miss work and spend a large portion of the day taking breaks, so teachers do the same. However, positively, ELMs were found to spend a large amount of their time out of their offices, travelling to or at schools providing instructional support.

¹Education officials include both LIGs and ELMs. LIGs are district leaders such as DEO, DIS, MEO and MIS. ELMs have a school support role such as CCTs, UNATU and ASSHU Representatives

² Source: World Bank Service Delivery Indicators (2013), <http://www.sdindicators.org/countries/Uganda>; SACMEQ 2007 data is consistent with this, too, as is data from TISSA 2014.



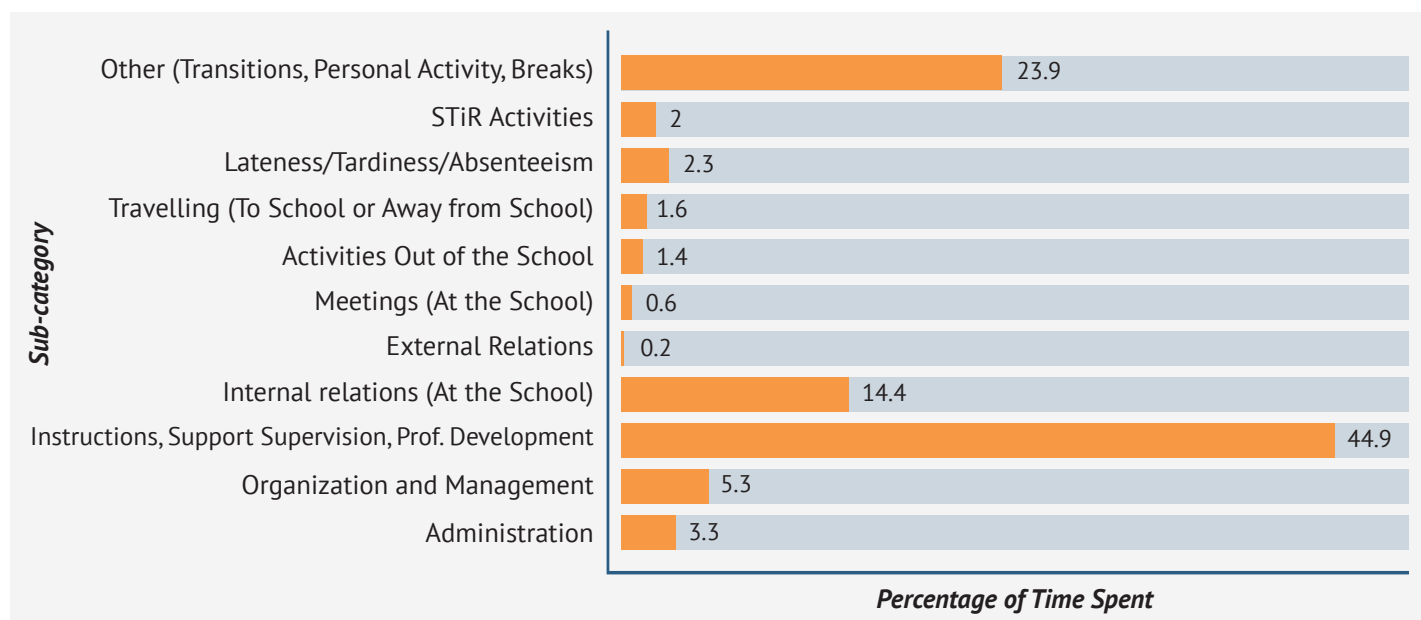
Teachers also spent about **20%** of their day in activities unrelated to teaching and learning.

While teachers, head teachers and education officials clearly report high levels of motivation, ensuring that they demonstrate this by regularly coming to work and spending their time on tasks related to teaching and learning will further their impact and the results they are gaining from participating in the STiR programme.

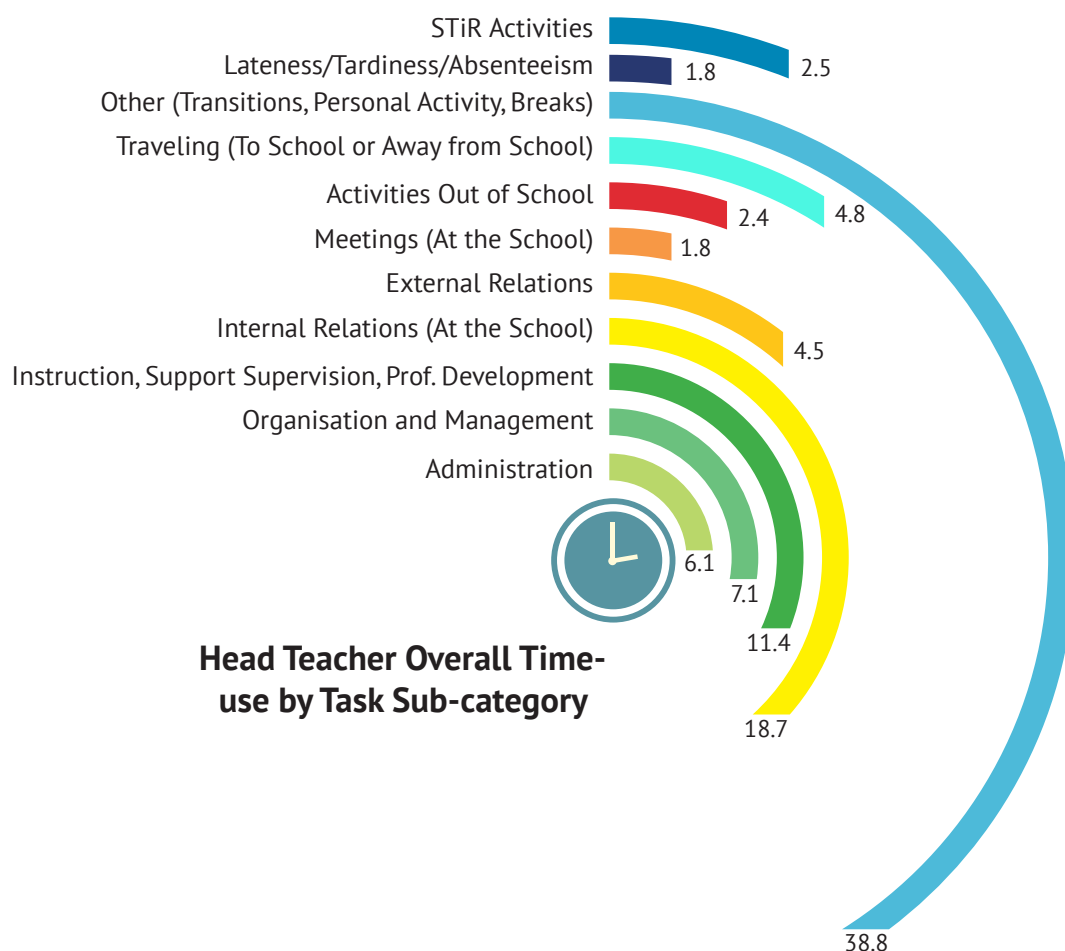
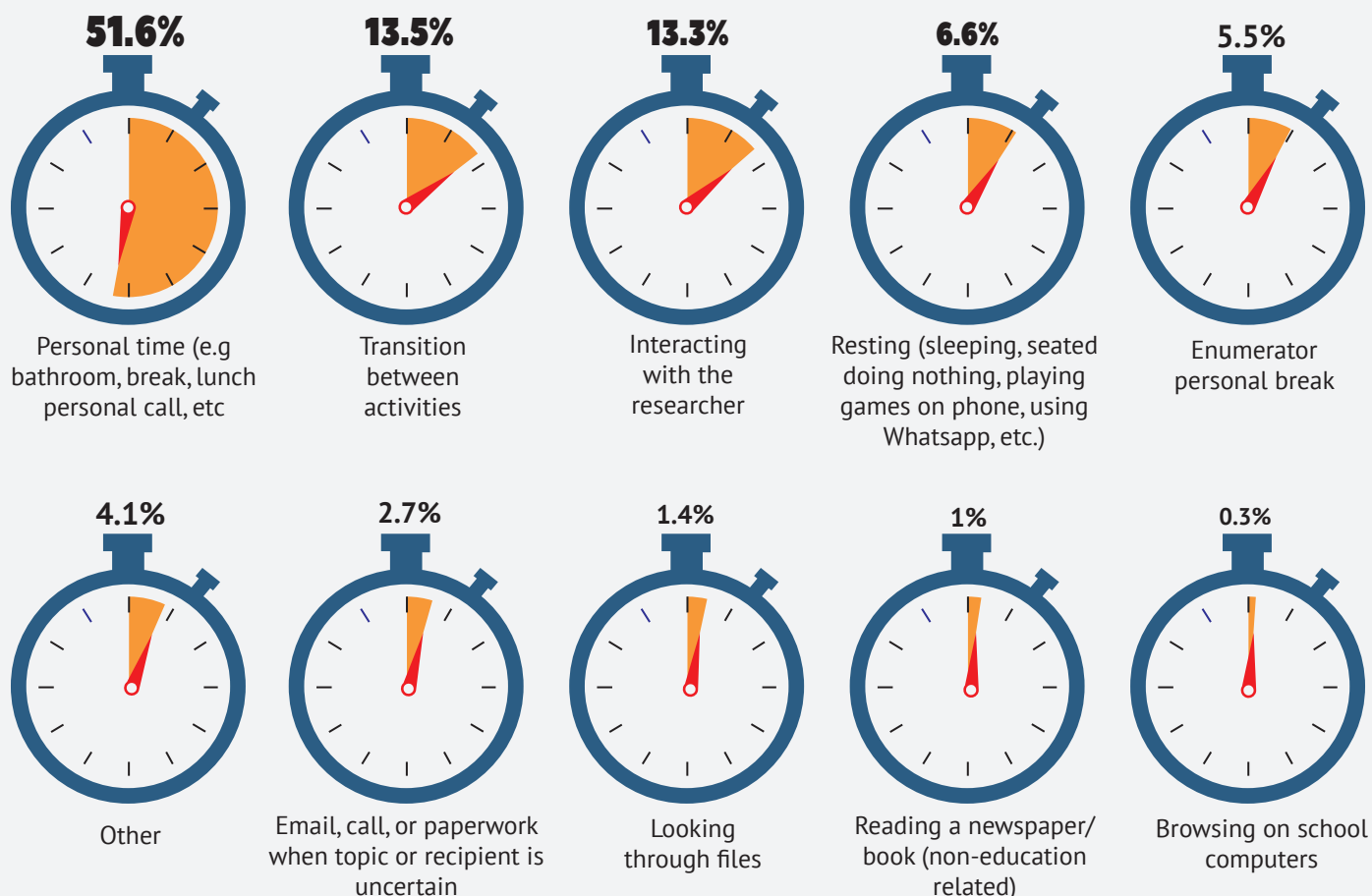
Table 6: Teacher and Head Teacher Absences Over Two Weeks

Number of self-reported absences over two weeks	Teacher					Head Teacher				
	1	2	3	4	5 or more	1	2	3	4	5 or more
All schools	59.56%	30.15%	5.88%	2.21%	1.48%	50.0%	32.50%	15.0%	0%	2.50%
Primary	58.33%	30.83%	6.67%	2.50%	1.67%	48.57%	31.43%	17.14%	0%	2.86%
Secondary	73.33%	26.67%	0%	0%	0%	60.0%	40.0%	0%	0%	0%
Males	62.34%	28.57%	5.19%	2.60%	1.30%	47.83%	30.43%	17.39%	0%	4.35%
Females	56.90%	32.76%	6.90%	1.72%	1.72%	52.94%	35.29%	11.76%	0%	0%

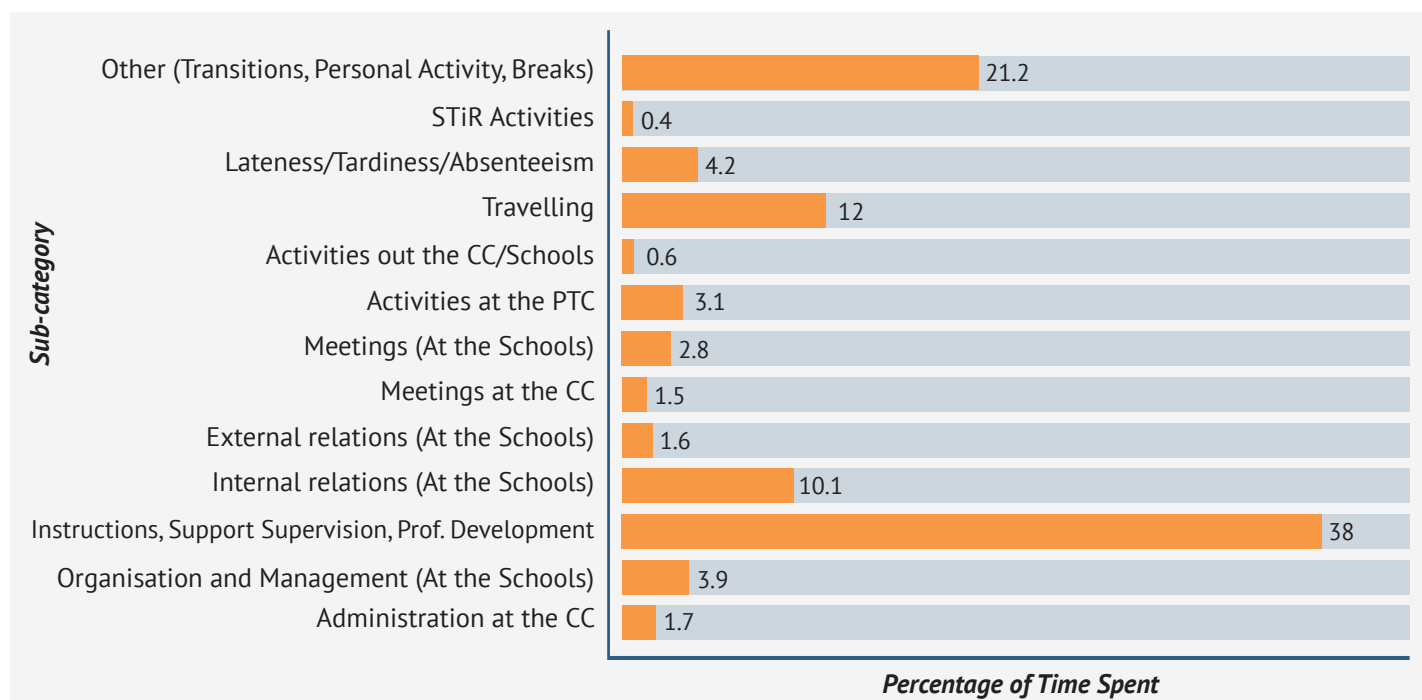
Graph 1: Teachers' Daily Time Use



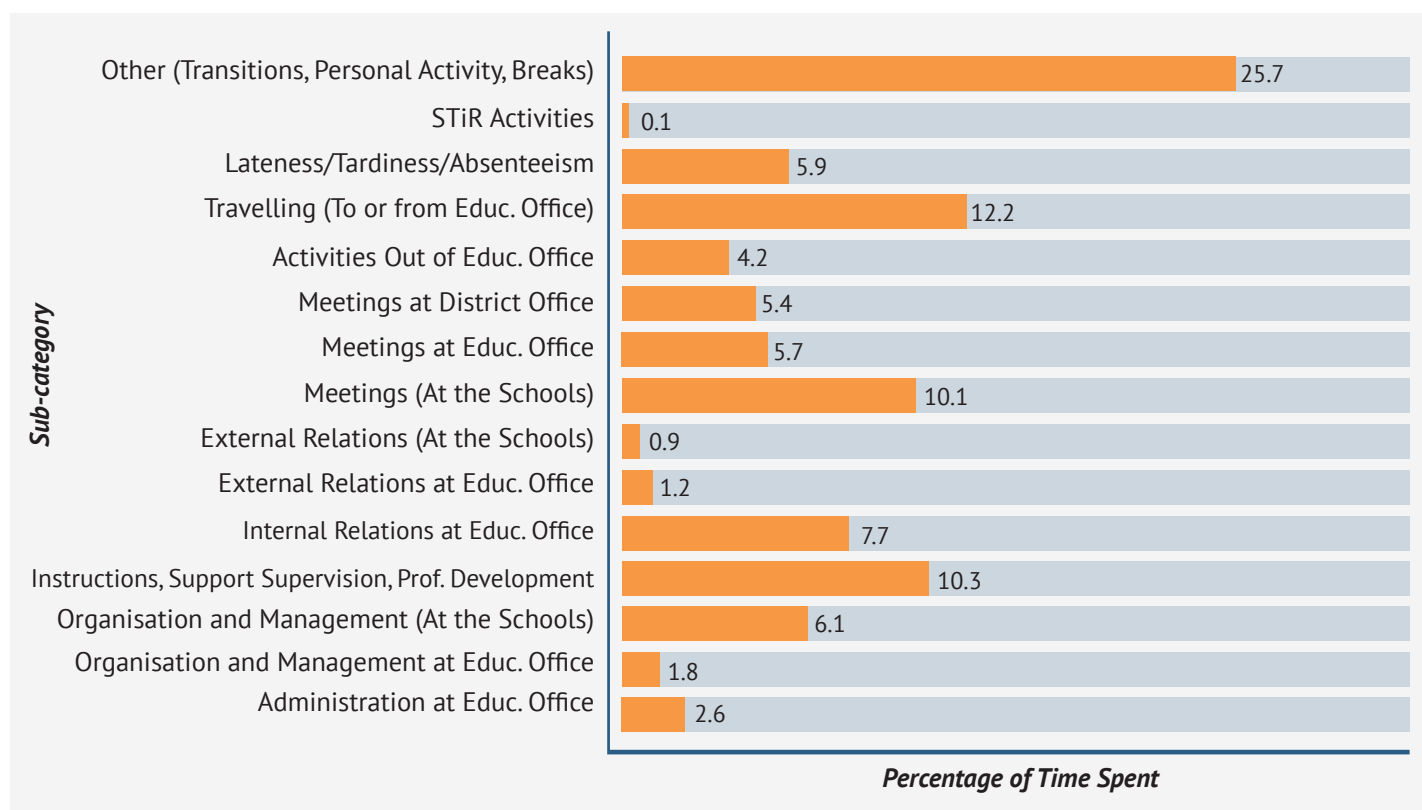
How Teachers Spend Their Non-Teaching Time (23.9% of their Overall Daily Time)



Graph 2: ELM Overall Time-use by Task Category



Graph 3: LIG Overall Time-use by Task Category



Headline Finding 2

Independent observations of STiR's programme activities indicate they are high-quality and well received by stakeholders, who actively engage in institutes, reflection and network meetings, and demonstrate significant levels of autonomy, mastery and purpose in their delivery of these activities. These findings were corroborated by teachers, head teachers and education officials who reported appreciating and readily participating in STiR activities to grow their skills and capacities.

STiR focuses on role-modelling and developing positive relationships amongst education system actors through Learning Improvement Cycles (LICs), which promote peer-to-peer linkages and provide learning opportunities. LICs are delivered through in-school network meetings for teachers, training institutes for head teachers and education officials, and planning and reflection meetings for district education actors. Measurement rubrics developed by STiR were used to observe and rate the quality of these activities against the three pillars of the intrinsic motivation model – autonomy, mastery and purpose using a 5-point scale where 5 is the best score. Part of a rubric used to evaluate the quality of one type of STiR activity (teacher network meetings) is shown in Figure 2 as an example.

Figure 2: Example of Rubric Used to Evaluate the Quality of a STiR Activity (Teacher Network Meetings)

STiR Network Meeting Rubric 2019					
	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3	Level 4	Level 5
	EL	EL	EL	EL	EL
Autonomy	1	Does most of the talking.	May be enthusiastic, but they prevent teachers from really being able to engage deeply with the subject matter by talking too much.	Ensures there is approximately 50% EL/teacher talk.	Ensures majority of meeting taken up by teacher discussion and practice.
	2	Time is not managed and often little relevant content is addressed	Attempts to manage time but not always effectively - some content is left out	Manages time well, with teachers discussing/practising for at least 50% of the meeting	The time is generally managed very well and all activities from the agenda are successfully completed.
	3				Meeting always starts on time
	4		Only asks superficial questions - they are virtually no 'probing' questions to promote deep discussion.	Enthusiastic and asks occasional probing questions	Asks lots of timely probing questions to drive quality discussions.
		TEACHERS	TEACHERS	TEACHERS	TEACHERS
	1	Do not listen or respond to each other's contributions.			The meeting is driven by teacher discussion and activity.
	2	May be talking, but no evidence it is relevant to the content.	There may be some group discussion, but it does not go beyond offering basic answers (e.g. no justification for views).	Discussion mostly but does not always stay on track (teachers may misunderstand the point about a particular practice, for instance, and begin talking about something else).	All on task for the full meeting
	3				May not consistently probe each other to push further, instead relying on the EL to play this role.
	4				Really probe each other to push thinking further.
					There is consistently exceptional punctuality without prompting

Independent observations found that activity quality was very high in study districts for most activities across the three pillars and primarily met STiR's progress pathway ambition for Year 2 of the programme. Teachers, head teachers and education officials were very positive about their participation in these activities, expressing appreciation for the process and content provided. These findings demonstrate a link between stakeholders' willingness to actively participate in training, professional development and learning and reflection actions and the overall quality of programme interventions. There were no significant differences between teacher and head teacher opinions or across genders.

However, despite strong self-reported appreciation for STiR activities, most scheduled in-school network meetings were not observed due to frequent cancelations and postponements. Teachers and head teachers stated that they do not always hold the recommended number of network meetings every term, though all schools hold at least one, and most hold at least two. This suggests that while teachers and head teachers report positively about participating in in-school professional development, effort is still needed to make them a regular, integral part of the school schedule.

Table 7: Quality Rubric Findings for Teacher Network Meetings in Term 2 and Term 3 2019

	Term 2 2019			Term 3 2019			Progress Pathway Ambition for Year 2 of the Programme: 2-3
Intrinsic Motivation Pillar	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	
Mbale District	3	2.5	3.5	1.7	3.3	3.7	
Pallisa District	4.6	3.8	4.6	N/A*	N/A*	N/A*	
Butebo District	3.7	3.3	3.3	N/A*	N/A*	N/A*	
Namutumba District	4	3	4	3	3	4	
Iganga District	4	4	5	3	3.5	4	

N/A* - Data was not collected in Pallisa and Butebo Districts in Term 3 2019.

Table 8: Quality Rubric Findings for SEL Institutes in Term 1 and Term 2 2019

	Term 1 2019			Term 2 2019			Progress Pathway Ambition for Year 2 of the Programme: 2-3
Intrinsic Motivation Pillar	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	
Mbale District	2	3	2	3	3.5	3	
Pallisa District	3	3	2	3	3	4	
Butebo District	3	3	3	3	3	4	
Namutumba District	3	3	2	4	4	4	
Iganga District	3	2	3	3	3.5	3.5	

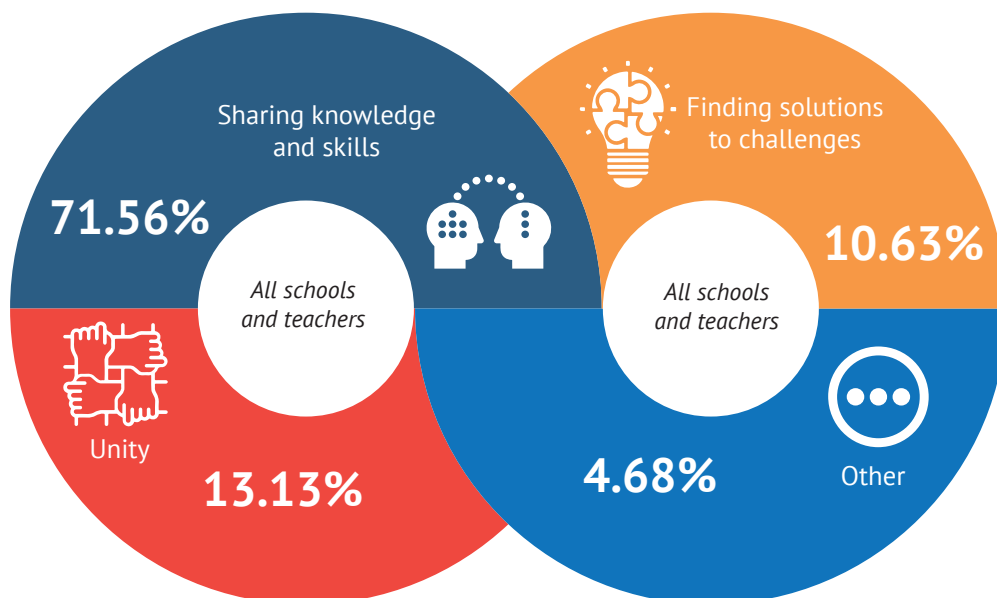
Table 9: Quality Rubric Findings for DEL Institutes in Term 1 and Term 2 2019

	Term 1 2019			Term 2 2019			Progress Pathway Ambition for Year 2 of the Programme: 2-3
Intrinsic Motivation Pillar	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	
DEL & LIG	4	3	4	2.8	3.3	3	

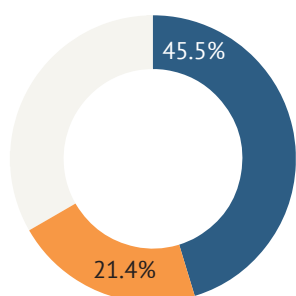
Table 10: Quality Rubric Findings for District Alignment Meetings in Term 2 2019

	Term 2 2019			Progress Pathway Ambition for Year 2 of the Programme: 2-3
Intrinsic Motivation Pillar	Autonomy	Mastery	Purpose	
Mbale District	4	4	4	
Pallisa District	4	4	4	
Butebo District	3	4	4	
Namutumba District	4	4	3	
Iganga District	4	4	3.5	

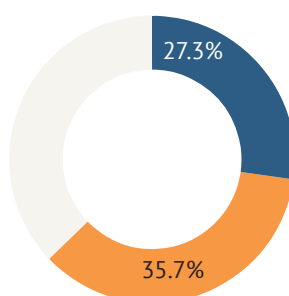
How do you benefit from collaborating with teachers in your school network?



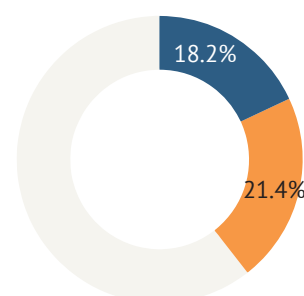
How Education Officials Say STiR Has Helped Them Grow in their Role



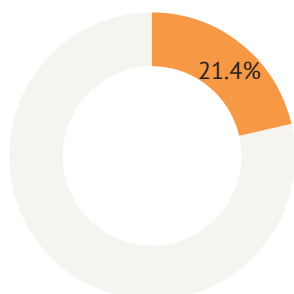
I have gained more skills



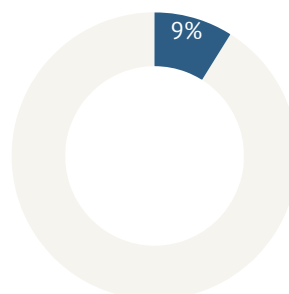
I have had a mindset change



I have been able to network



I have access to STiR innovations



Other



ELM LIG

4.2. ENGAGEMENT

Headline Finding 3

Students report liking school and are observed actively and readily engaging in classroom activities. This positively links to the observed actions of teachers in the classroom, notably regarding student praise and the equal engagement of boys and girls in lesson activities.

Student engagement in school is directly connected, in part, to quality teaching and the practices and attitudes teachers display in the classroom. Both primary and secondary students in the study overwhelmingly reported liking school and enjoying learning. Most students reported actively working on their assignments during class along with their peers; this was slightly higher for secondary students. The majority of primary and secondary students also reported a determination to solve class exercises, even if they were difficult, and excitement when learning new information even when they felt frustrated by a task.

Classroom observations demonstrated that students are generally engaged in classroom activities, follow the teacher's instructions, volunteer to participate in activities and contribute to class discussions. Improvement is still needed in student peer-to-peer collaboration, as most interactions happened between teachers and the whole class. There were no significant differences observed in these findings between primary and secondary classrooms.

Classroom observations positively found that teachers praise their students, call on them by name, and treat boys and girls equally. There were no significant differences observed in these findings between primary and secondary teachers, though secondary teachers were somewhat less likely to provide praise equally to all their students. Overall, these results suggest that teachers' application of inclusive teaching practices are positively impacting student engagement in the classroom and their enjoyment of school and learning.

95% of students reported liking school 'very much'



Table 11: Student Self-Reported Engagement in Class

		Never	1-2 days a week	3-4 days a week	5 days a week
All students	How often do you go outside while others are inside the class working?	57.31%	31.33%	7.79%	3.56%
Primary students		54.94%	32.62%	8.44%	4.01%
Secondary students		69.96%	24.51%	4.33%	1.20%
All students	How often do you sit inside class working while others are outside?	47.44%	28.78%	16.48%	7.30%
Primary students		48.90%	28.95%	16.23%	5.92%
Secondary students		39.76%	27.86%	17.77%	14.61%

Note: Classroom observations were measured on a 0-3 scale with 0 indicating the action was not observed at all and 3 indicating that the action was observed at the highest possible level of the scoring criteria. When reading the classroom observation tables in this report, it is important to look at the distribution of scores across 0-3, but also to look at the mean score, which shows the average score between 0-3 across all classroom observations.

Table 12: Classroom Observations of Student Engagement

			Distribution of scores			
	Mean	SD	0	1	2	3
Students are positive; they smile and follow the teacher's instructions and directions	2.37	0.75	4%	5%	41%	50%
Most (at least 75% of) students participate in class activities assigned by the teacher	2.57	0.79	5%	5%	20%	71%
Students volunteer to participate in the classroom activities	2.41	0.74	0%	15%	29%	56%
Most (at least 75% of) students embark on assigned activities or tasks readily	2.49	0.95	10%	4%	14%	73%
A range of students sitting in different parts of the room contribute to class discussions by trying to answer questions (even if they give the wrong answer)	2.18	1.08	14%	8%	23%	54%
Students collaborate with one another through peer interaction	1.16	1.3	52%	5%	18%	25%
Students ask their peers for clarification or help	0.71	0.96	58%	20%	16%	6%

Table 13: Classroom Observations of Inclusive Teaching Methods

	Mean	SD	Distribution of scores			
			0	1	2	3
Teacher provides praise to students equally, (instead of only some students) for positive responses, choices, or behaviour	2.04	1.16	19%	7%	24%	50%
The teacher does not exhibit gender bias and challenges gender stereotypes in the classroom	2.30	0.81	0%	23%	25%	52%
Teacher greets all students at the start of the lesson	2.48	1.08	15%	2%	4%	79%
Teacher calls on students by name during the lesson	2.00	1.07	13%	19%	24%	44%
Teacher calls on students in the class equally, instead of the same students repeatedly	2.65	0.76	5%	3%	14%	78%

Long-term impacts on student learning are critically affected by how teachers teach and whether they provide a positive learning environment for their students. For these impacts to grow over time, students and teachers need to be present in school and actively engaging in the teaching and learning process. Study findings also indicated, however, that students are frequently absent from school.

Nearly half of primary students and close to one-third of secondary students reported missing at least one day of school in the past two weeks. Results from attendance data collected at the schools during site visits showed that primary school absenteeism ranged from 27%-38% across all districts for both genders, while secondary school absenteeism ranged from 7%-41% across all districts for both genders.

While student absenteeism can be influenced by several factors – many of which may be outside of a students' control, such as illness or family commitments – time out of class can lead to disengagement from learning and affect overall motivation and educational gains. Student absenteeism should be explored further in subsequent evaluation points, as reducing both teacher and student absenteeism can have positive, important effects on their long-term growth and motivation.

Is there any day in the last 2 weeks that you did not come to school?

	YES	NO
All students	43.13%	56.87%

Primary students



Secondary students



Table 14: Student Attendance on Day of Classroom Observation

District	Primary Attendance on Day of Classroom Observation			Secondary Attendance on Day of Classroom Observation		
	Girls	Boys	Total	Girls	Boys	Total
Butebo	63%	61%	62%	87%	87%	87%
Iganga	63%	62%	63%	59%	60%	59%
Mbale	71%	72%	71%	82%	78%	73%
Namutumba	71%	72%	73%	94%	92%	93%
Pallisa	68%	67%	68%	65%	66%	67%
Average	68%	68%	68%	76%	74%	72%

Headline Finding 4

Routine observations of teachers and head teachers by education officials is positively related to reports of head teachers frequently observing their own teachers, and teachers reporting that they are regularly observed by their superiors. Direct, corresponding connections across this chain of stakeholders is a positive sign that observation processes are streamlined under the programme and highly prioritised by education actors.

Developing a culture of improvement that helps educators thrive is a key goal of STiR's programme. Observation and feedback loops between officials, head teachers and teachers is a critical part of this process to strengthen the instructional and administrative capacities of school actors.

The majority of teachers reported receiving observation visits from their head teacher or someone else on the school's management team, although fewer secondary teachers reported receiving this support than primary teachers. Most teachers reported being observed by their head teacher or someone else on the school's management team on a weekly, monthly or termly basis. Moreover, all the teachers and head teachers surveyed reported that local education officials observe them at least once per term; a significant number of teachers and head teachers reported that they are visited twice a term.

Disaggregated findings show differences between primary and secondary schools. Nearly 15% of secondary teachers reported that their head teacher never observes them, although secondary head teachers reported that they never fail to supervise any of their teachers. This discrepancy should be further examined because all head teachers have a mandate to observe all of their teachers at least once during the academic year. Notably, self-reported frequencies of observation visits – provided via long-term recall by respondents – has been proven in other studies to be unreliable and self-reported findings must be triangulated with other data points. Further exploring the genuineness of observation visits and their frequency in real time across stakeholders could provide a better lens on this metric in future evaluation points. We suggest utilising additional reporting mechanisms such as regular check-ins and programme staff observation.

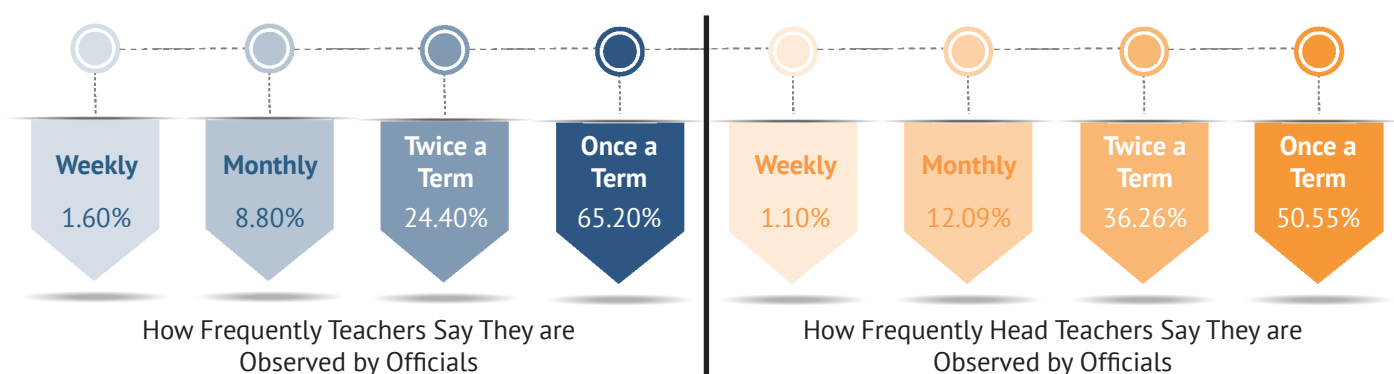
Positively, based on these findings, the consistency in observation visits reported across all education actors in the programme is encouraging and should be built upon going forward.

Table 15: Frequency of Self-Reported Teacher Observations from Head Teachers

How frequently does the head teacher or someone else in the management team observe you?				
	Never	Weekly	Monthly	Termly
All schools	3.35%	37.80%	34.76%	24.09%
Primary schools	1.43%	41.79%	36.79%	20.0%
Secondary schools	14.58%	14.58%	22.92%	47.92%
Males	4.23%	41.27%	34.39%	20.11%
Females	2.16%	33.09%	35.25%	29.50%

Table 16: Frequency of Self-Reported Head Teacher Observations of Teachers

How frequently do you observe, support, supervise or give feedback to your teachers?				
	Never	Weekly	Monthly	Termly
All schools	0%	47.12%	37.50%	15.38%
Primary schools	0%	50.0%	37.50%	12.50%
Secondary schools	0%	31.25%	37.50%	31.25%
Males	0%	38.33%	41.67%	20.0%
Females	0%	59.09%	31.82%	9.09%



Headline Finding 5

Teachers and head teachers reported receiving useful feedback from observations. However, teachers, head teachers and education officials admitted that the coaching provided during feedback sessions was primarily positive and focused on offering praise, rather than constructive advice to improve instructional practice. Despite this, teachers and head teachers reported that they are inspired by receiving praise and recognition from their superiors and consider it a critical driver of their intrinsic motivation.

Teachers and head teachers overwhelmingly reported that the coaching and feedback provided to them by education officials was useful. This is a positive sign that they value the support they receive from their superiors. However, feedback provided to teachers on their lesson scheming and planning from head teachers, managers and education officials rarely focused on ways to improve their instruction, centring instead on praise, thanks and encouragement; some teachers reported not receiving feedback at all. Only about 30% of all teachers reported receiving feedback that helped them improve their lesson schemes and plans. Secondary teachers were less likely overall to report receiving constructive feedback.

Nearly 100% of education officials reported praising teachers and recognising them for their best practices, including using 'good teaching practices', doing 'good work' and 'having good lesson plans'. Reasons for praising head teachers included doing 'good work', 'guiding teachers appropriately' and submitting timely reports. Around 60% of all education officials stated that teacher feedback should only be positive; the remainder identified that it should be both positive and constructive.

Findings indicate a link between the praise and appreciation that teachers and head teachers receive from education officials and their motivation. When asked when they felt motivated in the past week, 49% of teachers and 34% of head teachers identified that the greatest encouraging factor was being appreciated at work.

Positively, observation and feedback loops appear to be consistently implemented in most schools (as described in headline 4), which is in line with STiR's progress pathway ambition for establishing routines in Year 2. However, the coaching process delivered in these sessions must be strengthened and improved between Year 3 and Year 5, as projected in the progress pathway. Coaching provides the greatest benefits when it helps teachers and head teachers grow and develop their capacities; as such, it should be targeted, specific and corrective. Improving this process will likely support better school management by head teachers and higher quality instruction by teachers.

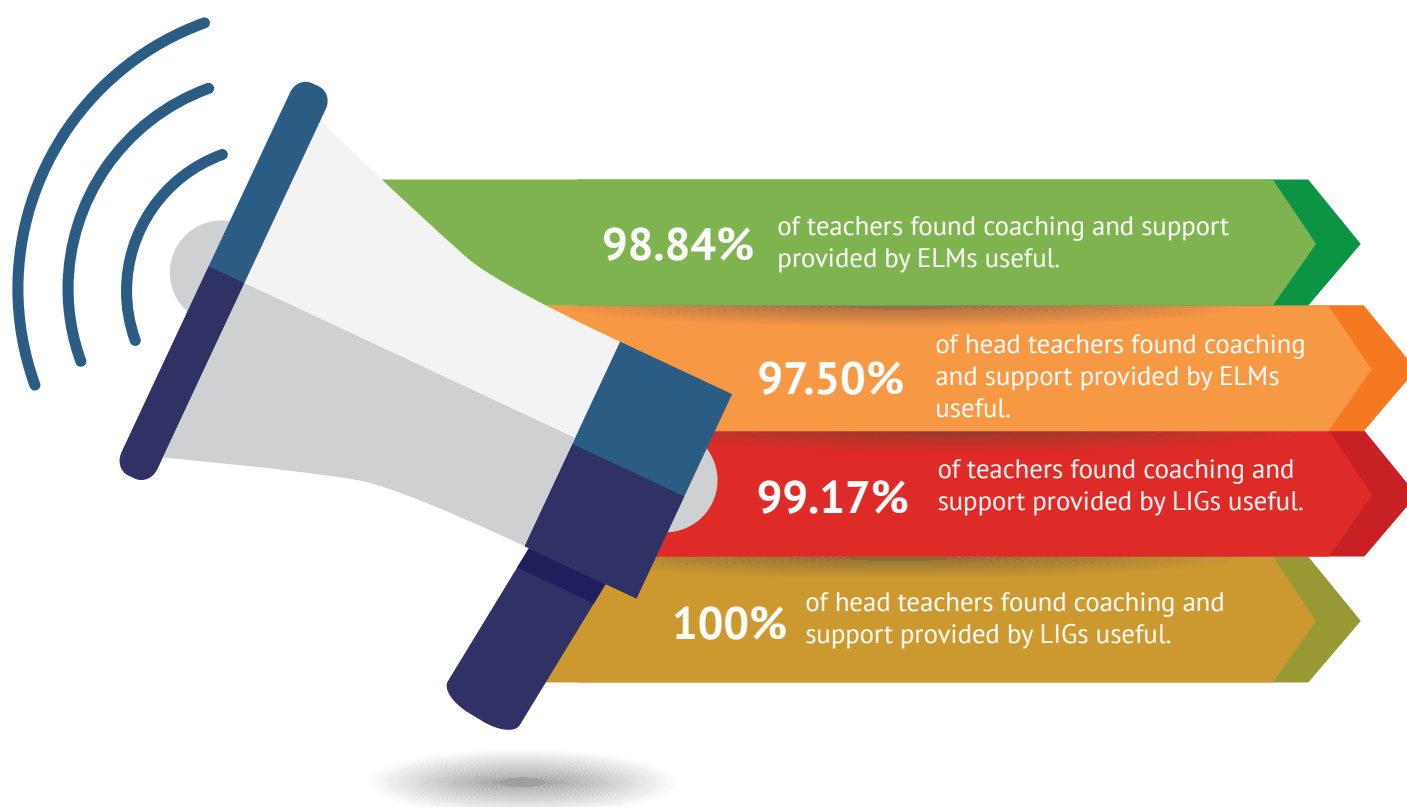


Table 17: Self-Reported Feedback Received by Teachers

		The reviewer thanked me and approved it	The reviewer asked for some corrections to be made	The reviewer encouraged me to keep up my work	No feedback received
All schools	Feedback on lesson schemes	54.46%	28.92%	13.23%	3.38%
	Feedback on lesson plans	55.10%	15.29%	22.93%	6.69%
Primary schools	Feedback on lesson schemes	52.67%	31.32%	13.88%	2.14%
	Feedback on lesson plans	51.81%	25.36%	16.67%	6.16%
Secondary schools	Feedback on lesson schemes	65.91%	13.64%	9.09%	11.36%
	Feedback on lesson plans	78.95%	5.26%	5.26%	10.53%
Males	Feedback on lesson schemes	51.87%	29.95%	15.51%	2.67%
	Feedback on lesson plans	55.0%	14.44%	26.67%	3.89%
Females	Feedback on lesson schemes	57.97%	27.54%	10.14%	4.35%
	Feedback on lesson plans	55.22%	16.42%	17.91%	10.45%



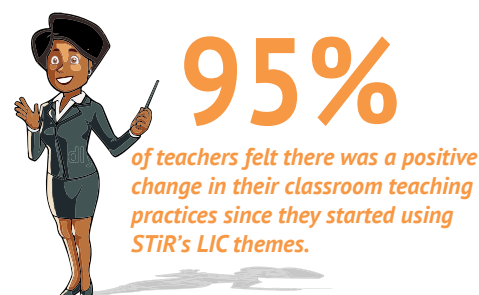
4.3. LEARNING TIME AND INTENTIONAL TEACHING

Headline Finding 6

Teachers overwhelmingly reported applying the instructional methods introduced by STiR and trying them in their classrooms, which aligns with observations of student engagement during lessons and teacher use of LIC themes in class. Teachers accurately described how they apply methods related to creating a positive learning environment, using learning aids, providing praise, checking for understanding and spacing practice to engage their learners. However, they were not as adept at correctly explaining how they promote a growth mind-set in their students, use effective and elaborative questioning techniques, or integrate retrieval practice in their lessons.

STiR's goal is for all children to be taught by teachers who are dedicated to improving their practice and spend most of their time in class maximising learning time for their students. Under the programme, teachers learn new skills and practices through network meetings, which engage them in a structured Learning Improvement Cycle (LIC) delivered by their head teacher using materials developed by STiR.

Teachers consistently reported trying out the teaching and learning practices they learn from network meetings most or all the time, and 95% felt there was a positive change in their classroom teaching practices since they started using STiR's LIC themes. When asked to describe each theme, teachers demonstrated high levels of understanding, especially for using learning aids, providing praise, checking for understanding and utilising spaced practice. Results for primary and secondary teachers showed no significant differences overall; secondary teachers did demonstrate a better understanding of giving feedback, but they were also less likely to correctly describe retrieval practice or dual coding.



Classroom observations showed that teachers are adept at articulating lesson objectives; breaking down information into easily understood parts; modelling how to complete tasks; and moving around the classroom during the lesson. Teachers were less frequently observed using spaced practice; summarizing key points from the lesson; using concept maps, think-pair-share, quizzes or tests; promoting peer interactions; or developing students' interpersonal skills. There were no significant differences observed in primary or secondary classrooms. However, classroom observations also indicated that teachers' instructional methods do not stimulate student curiosity or critical thinking and are largely devoted to whole group instruction. Teachers were least likely to correctly explain how to pose effective or elaborative questions to their students, which supports observation data.

Overall, findings positively indicate that teachers are consistently trying out new teaching strategies, which is a strong sign of their confidence and motivation, and in line with STiR's progress pathway ambition for establishing routines in Year 2. But, additional effort is needed between Year 3 and Year 5 to ensure teachers' confidence to try out new teaching strategies is also complemented by good practice because teachers must fully understand each teaching strategy and accurately apply it in class to maximise student learning and encourage higher level thinking skills.

Table 18: Teacher Self-Reported Understanding and Use of LIC Themes

LIC Theme	% of teachers reporting learning the practice from STiR	Frequency of Teachers Trying the Practice				% of teachers who correctly described the practice
		Never	Somewhat	Very Often	All the Time	
Use of learning aids	93.6%	2.9%	21.0%	37.9%	38.2%	98.0%
Positive praise	90.3%	1.3%	9.7%	37.9%	51.1%	96.2%
Checking for understanding	93.1%	0.7%	8.1%	43.6%	47.7%	96.1%
Classroom layout and seating arrangement	87.1%	3.9%	19.0%	35.6%	41.6%	90.9%
Positive learning environment	89.5%	4.0%	21.5%	37.3%	37.3%	90.0%
Spaced practice	82.0%	6.7%	23.9%	39.9%	29.5%	89.4%
Physical and emotional learning environment	79.6%	7.3%	24.4%	41.2%	27.1%	86.6%
Classroom code of conduct	87.2%	3.5%	16.7%	39.4%	40.4%	78.0%
Retrieval practice	82.1%	4.8%	23.3%	36.3%	35.6%	77.8%
Dual coding	62.1%	15.7%	27.3%	35.4%	21.7%	69.9%
Growth mind-set	85.8%	0%	26.0%	39.4%	34.6%	68.1%
Effective questioning	86.9%	2.8%	21.0%	37.4%	38.8%	65.7%
Giving feedback	94.0%	1.0%	12.1%	40.9%	46.0%	63.9%
Elaborative questioning	80.6%	7.5%	29.3%	35.3%	27.8%	29.0%

Table 19: Teacher Application of Specific Teaching Practices

			Distribution of scores			
	Mean	SD	0	1	2	3
Teacher explicitly articulates the objectives of the lesson and relates classroom activities to the objectives	2.44	.75	0%	16%	24%	60%
Teacher separates material/breaks down information into component parts so that the information can be easily understood by the students; the teacher's explanation of content is clear	2.54	.95	10%	2%	13%	76%
Teacher makes connections in the lesson that relate to students' existing content knowledge or their daily lives	2.15	.93	0%	37%	11%	52%
Teacher uses spaced practice (e.g. refers to previous lessons/materials with similar topics already taught to help students understand the new material)	1.60	1.2	28%	17%	23%	32%
Teacher models how to complete a task by demonstrating the task and/or explaining what they are doing or thinking as they do the task (e.g. thinking aloud)	2.32	.84	0%	24%	20%	56%
Teacher summarizes key points of lesson at the end of lesson	1.05	1.21	52%	9%	20%	19%
The teacher uses questions, prompts or other strategies to check students level of understanding	1.92	1.08	14%	21%	24%	41%
Teacher gives students opportunities to demonstrate their understanding of a lesson (e.g. in front of class, by calling on them in their seat, etc.)	2.03	1.11	17%	10%	27%	47%
Teacher circulates/moves around the classroom during an exercise (from front, to the sides and to the back of the class)	2.28	.95	8%	11%	26%	55%
Teacher monitors most students during independent/group work	1.90	1.2	23%	7%	26%	44%
Teacher adjusts their teaching to the level of student understanding (e.g. teacher responds to students' level of understanding before moving on to the next step in the lesson)	2.08	1.16	19%	6%	22%	53%
Teacher checks/marks students' assignments and homework during the lesson	1.43	1.27	39%	10%	22%	30%
% of students whose work was checked (0. 1-25%, 1. 26-50%, 2. 51-75%, 3. 76-100%)	1.66	1.07	19%	22%	32%	27%
Teacher uses visual images or learning aids to match their verbal explanations to increase students' understanding or retention of information	1.14	1.34	54%	7%	10%	29%
Teacher uses concept maps, think pair share, quizzes or tests, to increase students' understanding or retention of information	0.95	1.24	60%	5%	16%	19%
Teacher promotes students' collaboration through peer interaction	0.78	1.19	68%	3%	12%	17%
Teacher promotes students' interpersonal skills (such as perspective taking, empathizing, emotion regulation, collaborating/sharing and problem-solving)	0.75	1.1	64%	8%	15%	12%

Headline Finding 7

Teachers reported that they are regularly observed by their peers and that feedback from these visits helps them to improve their practice. Unlike the coaching and feedback provided by head teachers and education officials, which is primarily focused on praise, peer-to-peer learning within the programme appears to be highly appreciated by teachers and provides a stronger basis for constructive support.

Teachers reported receiving feedback from their peers on their teaching and that the feedback was useful, although secondary teachers were less likely than primary teachers to report this. Most teachers, across school type and gender, believe that peer observation is important because it helps them identify their strengths and weaknesses and improve their teaching. Some teachers also stated that feedback increases their confidence or helps them learn new things. Teachers reported that they are observed by their peers on a weekly, monthly or termly basis, although secondary teachers were more likely to report never being observed or receiving feedback by a peer.

These findings suggest that peer-to-peer mentorship under the STiR programme, especially in primary schools, is frequent and provides teachers with constructive inputs to help them grow as educators. This is significant, as creating a basis for continuous professional development within a school environment, rather than only from external support mechanisms, is critical to growing the skills of teachers and creating a culture of professionalism with colleagues. It is possible to leverage the results from these findings to improve the coaching and feedback content provided by head teachers and education officials in the programme to strengthen the observation process and provide teachers with the support they need to develop their capacities.

Table 20: Teacher Self-Reported Observations by Peer Teachers

How frequently does a peer teacher observe you teaching in class and give you feedback?				
	Never	Weekly	Monthly	Termly
All schools	9.15%	40.24%	26.83%	23.78%
Primary schools	5.71%	43.93%	28.21%	22.14%
Secondary schools	29.17%	18.75%	18.75%	33.33%
Males	8.60%	36.02%	29.57%	25.81%
Females	9.86%	45.77%	23.24%	21.13%

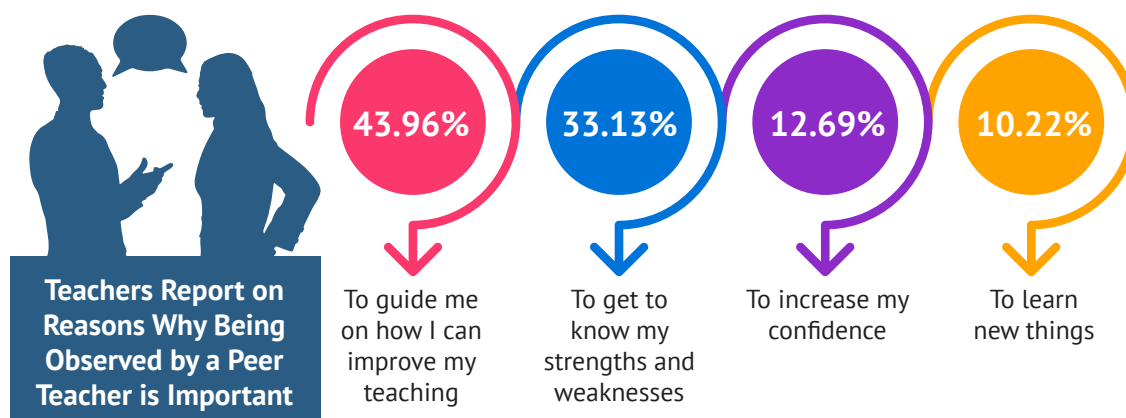


Table 21: Teacher Opinions on Instructional Improvements from Peer Feedback

Do you feel you have improved as a result of peer observation and feedback?			
	Not at all	Somewhat	Very much
All schools	8.68%	30.24%	61.08%
Primary schools	6.34%	30.63%	63.03%
Secondary schools	22.0%	28.0%	50.0%
Males	7.81%	29.69%	62.50%
Females	9.86%	30.99%	59.15%

4.4. FOUNDATIONS OF CURIOSITY AND CRITICAL THINKING

Headline Finding 8

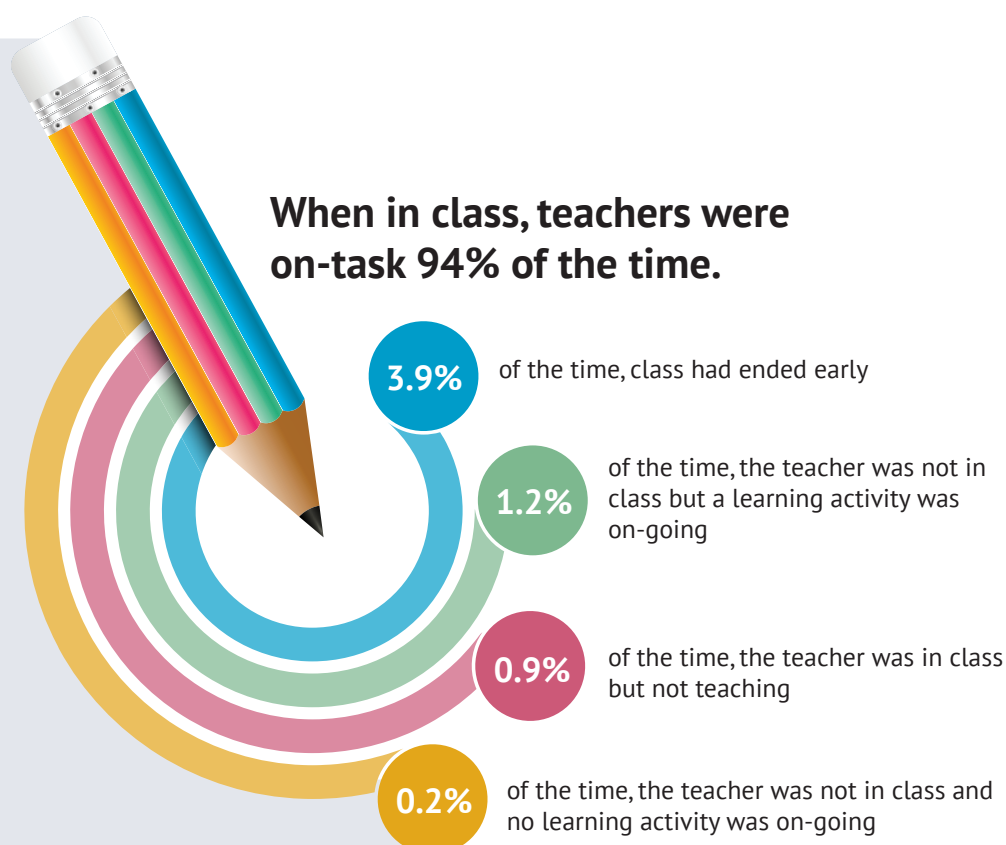
Teacher time on task in the classroom is high and devoted to relevant, subject-related teaching and learning activities. But, most class activities are teacher-led and primarily involve whole group work. This corresponds to observed limitations in teachers' ability to develop the critical and creative thinking abilities of their students during lessons, despite their demonstrated ability to deliver relevant content and information through lecture-based learning techniques.

Teachers must analyse, evaluate and contextualise their teaching strategies to support the development of student curiosity and critical thinking. Teachers were observed in their classrooms to record how often they were on-task and actively engaging with students or off-task, either in class but not actively engaging with their students or out of class entirely when they should have been teaching. Observations also recorded the types of activities teachers used to engage students to evaluate how they grow students' curiosity and critical thinking skills.

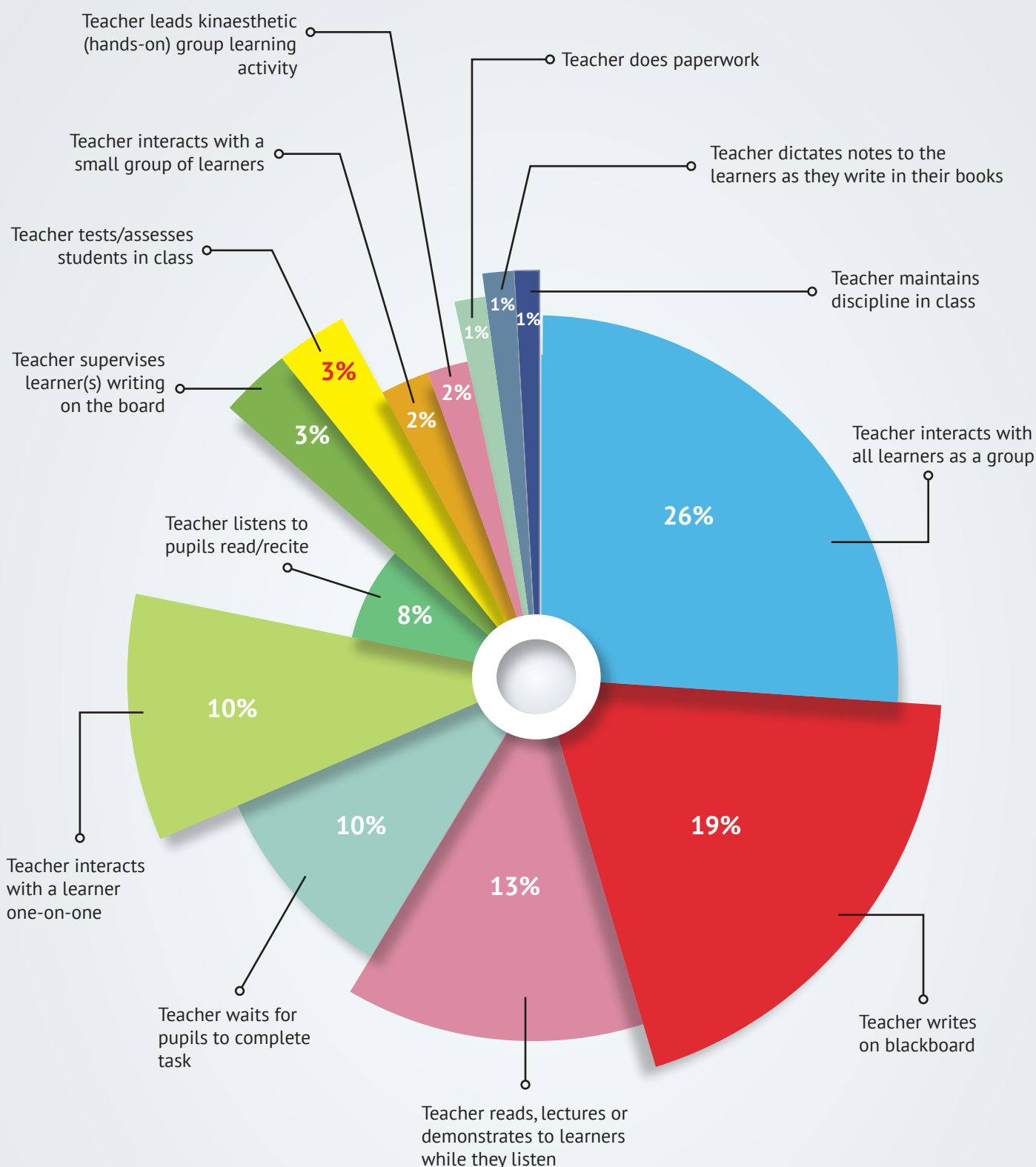
Findings indicate that teachers were on-task almost 94% of the time, spending only 6% of class time in off-task activities. Despite the high teacher absenteeism rates and time spent on non-education tasks throughout the school day (which were reported in headline 1), when teachers are in the classroom they demonstrate positive behaviours towards instruction and engage in relevant teaching and learning actions.

Teachers spent a significant amount of class time interacting with learners as a whole group; writing on the blackboard; and reading, lecturing or demonstrating as students listened. Less time was spent interacting with small groups of learners; engaging students in hands-on tasks; or assessing students on what they learned. These actions mean less class time is spent on tasks that could stimulate student's curiosity and critical thinking skills, such as working in small groups or having students demonstrate their understanding. Very few teachers were also observed asking their students open-ended questions, instead focusing on basic recall of facts. There were no significant differences in findings between primary and secondary teachers.

Although teachers were infrequently observed engaging students in critical thinking tasks and stimulating their curiosity, students reported applying academic concepts to their lives outside of school. 52.38% of students said they had used an academic concept and applied it to a situation outside of school; 95.74% of those students said that this made them 'excited to learn more'. These are positive findings pointing to the willingness of students to extend learning beyond the classroom to be challenged by new content. This could provide an entry point for further teacher training to ensure educators are able to apply effective techniques that help students develop deeper curiosity and critical thinking skills.



Average Percentage of Time Spent on Teacher Actions in Class



Note: A breakdown of classroom activities by 3 minute snapshots is provided in the Annex.

Key findings from these snapshots show that students do not get a gradual release from teacher-led activities to group activities to individual work; time spent on whole class work and the teacher writing on the blackboard remains consistently high throughout the lesson while small group work, students writing on the blackboard, students reading/reciting and pupils working individually remains consistently low throughout.

Overall, teacher-led activities dominate most lessons and there is not a lot of time spent on students working in small groups or individually. Positively, little time was spent on discipline and on the teacher doing paperwork.

Table 22: Classroom Observations of Critical Thinking Practices

			Distribution of scores			
	Mean	SD	0	1	2	3
Teacher asks students questions to enable them to recall basic facts and concepts	2.04	1.05	14%	11%	31%	43%
Teacher asks careful/effective questions that get students to really think about things deeply (beyond basic recall of facts or concepts – asking how or why questions)	1.26	1.19	39%	19%	20%	22%
Teacher asks open-ended questions (e.g. question requires more than a yes/no or single word answer)	1.21	1.24	46%	10%	22%	23%
Teacher gives students critical or creative thinking tasks during the lesson	1.66	.82	0%	56%	22%	22%
Students ask open-ended questions or perform critical or creative thinking tasks	0.59	1.04	72%	6%	11%	10%
% of students who raised hands to ask questions (0. 1-25%, 1. 26-50%, 2. 51-75%, 3. 76-100%)	1.32	.73	80%	11%	6%	3%
% of students who raised hands to answer questions (0. 1-25%, 1. 26-50%, 2. 51-75%, 3. 76-100%)	2.71	1.05	16%	24%	31%	28%
Teacher provides students with choices (students are given options about how a learning activity should be completed)	1.85	.92	0%	51%	13%	36%
Teacher provides students with opportunities to take on roles in the classroom	2.10	.82	0%	29%	31%	39%

4.5. SAFETY

Headline Finding 9

Teachers self-reported and were observed being welcoming and friendly towards students and calling on them by name. This corresponds to students reporting liking school and feeling safe in their academic environment. But, conversely, both teachers and students reported that corporal punishment is a common method of discipline, indicating a disconnect between purported feelings of safety at school and normalized physical punishment practices.

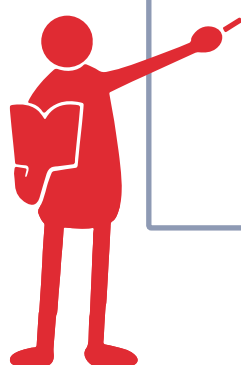
The STiR programme aims to create school and classroom environments where children are physically and emotionally safe. Teachers and school leaders are morally and legally responsible for this outcome, and must be trained and empowered to implement positive discipline techniques.

97.3% of all students reported feeling safe at their school, and 96.8% reported feeling safe in their classroom. Classroom observations support this, as teachers were seen treating all students respectfully, using positive and encouraging language, and creating an emotional connection with their students. There were no significant differences in findings between primary and secondary teachers. Additionally, most teachers could accurately describe how to create a positive and physically and emotionally safe learning environment in their classrooms.



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97% of students reported feeling safe at school and in their classrooms
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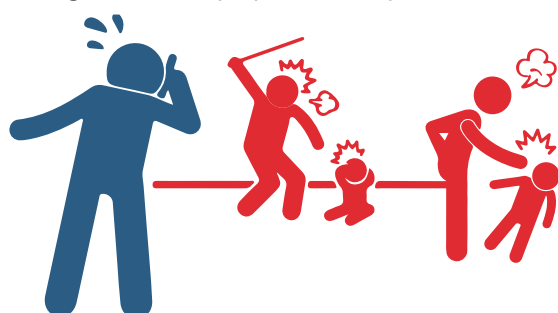
However, teachers also self-reported that they use physical discipline on their students. About one-third of teachers and one-quarter of head teachers reported that physical punishment is an accepted form of discipline in their school for misbehaving children. Slightly more male than female teachers believe this. This inconsistency indicates that teachers might conceptually understand how to create a safe and positive classroom, but do not see corporal punishment as contradictory to these practices.



About one-third of teachers and one-quarter of head teachers reported that physical punishment is an accepted form of discipline in their school for misbehaving children



More than half of the students surveyed reported seeing another student being physically punished in school either daily or weekly. Education officials reported being well-aware of corporal punishment practices in schools and to frequently witnessing it during school visits; 25% of ELMs said they had seen teachers disciplining students with a cane, object, or their hand within the past month. These findings indicate an overall tolerance – and possibly an acceptance – of corporal punishment in schools, allowing teachers to perpetuate the practice.



25% of ELMs said they had seen teachers disciplining students with a cane, object, or their hand within the past month

Additionally, there appears to be a disconnect between students' purported feelings of safety in school and their acceptance of physical discipline. When asked if they believed the best way to discipline a student who breaks the rules or disobeys a teacher was through caning or physical punishment, 65.11% of students agreed. These results suggest that students may not necessarily correlate being physically punished at school with feeling unsafe. It is possible that corporal punishment at home and school are normalised for many students, and that they are unaware that caning is a characteristic of an unsafe school.



When asked if they believed the best way to discipline a student who breaks the rules or disobeys a teacher was through caning or physical punishment,

65.11%

of students agreed

Going forward, it is important to involve education stakeholders and students in targeted activities to promote positive discipline and improve the safety and emotional well-being of all learners.

Table 23: Self-Reported Corporal Punishment Practices by Teachers and Head Teachers

Have you ever caned a child in your class for misbehaving?	Teacher		Head Teacher	
	Yes	No	Yes	No
All schools	67.96%	32.04%	56.48%	43.52%
Primary schools	69.72%	30.28%	59.34%	40.66%
Secondary schools	58.0%	42.0%	41.18%	58.82%
Males	71.88%	28.13%	54.84%	45.16%
Females	62.68%	37.32%	58.70%	41.30%

Table 24: Frequency of Corporal Punishment Reported by Students

	Daily	Weekly	Monthly	Rarely	Never	Other
All schools	20.4%	34.6%	2.8%	29.0%	12.9%	0.3%
Primary schools	20.9%	36.5%	2.6%	27.0%	12.8%	0.4%
Secondary schools	17.9%	24.9%	3.7%	39.8%	13.8%	0%

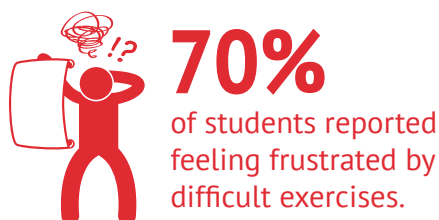
4.6. SELF-ESTEEM

Headline Finding 10

Students reported high levels of determination and grit related to their academic learning. This is connected to observations of teachers encouraging students to set goals, providing them with corrective and specific feedback during lessons, acknowledging their efforts, and having a positive attitude towards helping students address their learning challenges.

Self-esteem is a critical factor in ensuring students have positive beliefs about their capacity to learn. Teachers are integral to this process, as they must support and encourage their students to work hard and achieve in school.

Students largely indicated that they are confident dealing with challenging academic tasks in the classroom. Although about 70% of students reported feeling frustrated by difficult exercises, more than 80% said they were determined to solve the problem; this sentiment was higher among secondary students. More than 60% of primary students and 70% of secondary students also expressed that they were excited to try to learn more after tackling a challenging exercise.



Most primary and secondary students reported being able to successfully complete at least half of the difficult exercises they are confronted with at school. They also reported using problem-solving strategies like asking their teacher for help or working with other students to solve these exercises. Teacher responses corroborated this, with many reporting that they frequently work with struggling students to help them learn difficult content. This suggests that teachers' instructional strategies may be positively impacting student self-esteem related to learning.

Classroom observations of teachers indicated that they encourage their students, frequently acknowledge their efforts and positively respond to their challenges. Teachers also demonstrated goal setting and were frequently observed giving students corrective feedback. However, when teachers were asked to explain and give an example of this practice, only 64% could do this correctly. Helping teachers refine their feedback and support practices will improve their instruction, which will likely have a positive impact on furthering students' self-esteem related to learning.

Table 25: Student Responses to Difficult Exercises

	Frustrated that it was hard to solve	Bored waiting to hear the answer	Sad because others had an easier time than me	Excited to try to learn more	Determined to learn how to solve the problem
All students	69.53%	34.82%	54.67%	62.15%	83.42%
Primary students	69.72%	35.57%	55.67%	60.65%	82.07%
Secondary students	68.50%	30.60%	49.0%	70.57%	91.02%

Table 26: Teacher Actions to Support Student Achievement

	Distribution of scores					
	Mean	SD	0	1	2	3
The teacher acknowledges students' efforts	1.92	1.06	15%	15%	32%	38%
The teacher has a positive attitude towards students' challenges	2.08	.9	0%	37%	18%	45%
Students ask the teacher for clarification or help with an assignment or task	0.4	.81	76%	12%	8%	4%
The teacher encourages goal setting among students (both short and long term goals)	1.27	.63	0%	84%	6%	10%
Teacher provides corrective feedback to students based on their verbal answers to questions	1.95	1.18	22%	6%	27%	45%
Teacher provides corrective feedback to students based on written or assigned work completed	1.46	1.26	37%	8%	25%	29%
Teacher provides specific feedback that points out students' successes or correct answers	1.29	1.08	29%	32%	20%	19%



5.1. MEASURING SAFETY AND PUNISHMENT

One of the most important findings of the first year of the study relates to student safety in classrooms and schools. While students nearly unanimously reported that they feel safe at school, they also reported frequent use of physical punishment by teachers, either towards themselves or other students. Teachers and head teachers themselves reported knowing that the use of physical punishment is wrong – and even illegal – but that it is also useful and appropriate at times to respond proportionately to student actions. These findings raise the question of whether students' self-reported feelings of safety in the classroom are aligned to a (generally accepted) belief that a 'safe' school is one where punishment is not mediated physically by teachers.

In Uganda, as in many other countries worldwide, physical punishment for infractions is a common occurrence at school and at home. As such, students (and teachers) may not link corporal punishment with a lack of safety in their school and might, on the contrary, believe it is an acceptable and normal practice. Changing these deep seated cultural and social beliefs about safety and punishment takes long-term behaviour change on the part of both teachers and students. This will be a key challenge for STiR to tackle in the future.

These findings also raise the question of whether we should explore alternative metrics to measure safety in the classroom and school environment during future evaluation points to assess progress on the STiR's indicators related to physically and emotionally safe learning environments. Moreover, educating teachers about effective, non-physical ways to discipline students is a clear professional development area where further work is needed. Parents, communities and local education officials should also be brought on board to support this and address school-based violence.

5.2. MEASURING INTRINSIC MOTIVATION

Findings from the first year of the study indicate that key stakeholders positively report high levels of intrinsic motivation and satisfaction with the programme, stating that their participation in activities has brought about a positive mind set change. Findings also demonstrate that the programme has helped to develop a culture of sharing and learning among education officials, teachers and head teachers. These are all very positive outcomes from the programme that can be built on going forward.

However, while all stakeholders reported high levels of intrinsic motivation and satisfaction with their participation in the STiR programme, they often referred to extrinsic factors, such as low salaries and lack of benefits, as influencing their motivation to perform their roles and to continue developing as professionals. In addition, the study found high self-reported levels of absenteeism amongst teachers, head teachers and education officials, as well as observations during shadowing activities that about 20% of their time is spent doing tasks unrelated to learning or school improvement. These are significant findings, as reduced rates of time spent on tasks related to improving teaching and learning – coupled with reduced instructional time due to absenteeism from the workplace – mean that there is less than optimal effort and energy spent on actions that can improve learning outcomes and teacher effectiveness in general.

Further investigation of teachers' self-efficacy is pertinent for later evaluation cycles. Evidence from other research on motivation shows that external factors related to feelings about pay, societal status and working conditions, as well as observable behaviours like absenteeism, are proxy measures for measuring motivation levels at work. Studies show that self-efficacy is central to motivation because "teachers who believe that they cannot achieve their goals – whether they attribute this to their personal shortcomings, to aspects of the environment, or some combination of the two – are unlikely to put much effort into working towards them." (Stuart Cameron, 2015). Moreover, research from a teacher development study in Nigeria has linked low pay, poor working conditions and low societal status for teachers to low teacher motivation, high absenteeism and high attrition rates (Teacher Development Programme TDP Evaluation Framework and Plan, EDOREN, December 2014).

Although STiR does not focus its inputs on addressing extrinsic factors in stakeholder motivation, absenteeism and time spent off task are clearly areas that can affect the overall development of teachers, and programme impacts and sustainability at the end of five years. Through the system strengthening pathway of the programme, it might be worthwhile in the coming phase to work with local and national education officials as well as school leaders to confront these issues and find ways – through the system – to address factors related to extrinsic motivation and unauthorised and unnecessary absenteeism. Tackling the challenges involved in addressing poor extrinsic motivation involves engaging stakeholders themselves in system level changes that can positively affect the external factors related to their jobs. STiR can participate in this by feeding back findings from Year 1 of the study (and continuing to collect relevant data about it in Year 2) and helping stakeholders determine ways to influence extrinsic motivation within the boundaries of their roles and positions within the education system.

5.3. MEASURING TEACHER PERFORMANCE

For Year 1 of the study, Ichuli developed a tool for classroom observations derived from the World Bank's internationally recognised TEACH tool. The TEACH tool includes 28 teacher and student behaviours within 9 areas that receive overall performance scores of 1-5. The World Bank recommends that enumerators using the TEACH tool undergo one full week of training to learn, in detail, how to utilise the tool and score findings according to TEACH guidelines. This is necessary because the TEACH tool (and tools modelled on it) are subjective and require enumerators to have a strict understanding of the tool's rubric used to score the quality of each teaching and learning behaviour. At the end of the week of training, an exam is administered to ensure trainees have accurately grasped the TEACH tool rating system and to ensure their inter-rater reliability.

Our classroom observation tool adapted the TEACH tool's original 1-5 rating system and instead used a 0-3 rating system in an effort to simplify it and make it more user-friendly for enumerators. It was piloted during Year 1 of the study and contributed to valuable results about teacher and student classroom behaviour in STiR programme schools; however, we identified some key areas for improvement before utilising it again in Year 2 of the study. First, enumerators using the tool could be taken through an intensive week of training to thoroughly understand how to use it and ensure accurate results with inter-rater reliability. Ichuli's staff are certified TEACH tool trainers and can use the principles and guidelines learned from their TEACH master training to achieve this. This would allow us to continue using the tool in the field at a large scale, but comes with trade-offs in terms of the time and resources necessary for conducting a large-scale training of enumerators on only one tool for a full week.

Another option is to train only a small number of enumerators on the tool for one week. While this would have the same implication in terms of time (one week of training), it would require fewer resources in terms of the number of enumerators trained. This option, however, would have implications for data collection. If Year 2 of the study were to target the same number of schools and classrooms as in Year 1, a reduced number of trained enumerators conducting classroom observations would have several logistical and time implications. This approach may work best if Year 2 of the study focuses on a smaller selection of schools and classrooms, but takes a 'deeper dive' by conducting several classroom observations over a longer school visit. A third option would be to send enumerators who have not received a TEACH tool-style training to the field to videotape lessons. These videos could be post-scored using the Quality of Teaching tool by Ichuli's staff and a small group of enumerators who are trained to use it properly. This option could allow for the collection of a large number of observations while reducing inputs related to enumerator training. There are some limitations to not scoring the observations live in the classroom, but these could be justified to deliver accuracy in results and value for money.

Alternatively, the number of teaching practices that enumerators are required to observe when using the current tool are too numerous to ensure accuracy and reliability. The TEACH tool includes 28 teaching practices to observe, but our Quality of Teaching Tool includes 60 teaching practices. Additional practices were included in the tool (alongside TEACH practices), as STiR wanted to observe whether teachers were utilising their LIC themes in the classroom and to track findings against STiR's key performance indicators for teacher instruction. In practice, observing and rating 60 teaching practices while in the field is extremely difficult, even for well-trained and seasoned enumerators. It is recommended to reduce the number of teaching practices on the tool in the future, especially if we continue scoring live lessons in the field. If observations are videotaped and post-scored, it might be possible to keep a larger number of practices on the tool. However, reducing the number of teacher and student behaviours overall will ensure we focus on collecting the most important information for the evaluation.

5.4. MEASURING THE QUALITY OF STiR ACTIVITIES USING RUBRICS

During Year 1 of the study, Ichuli used STiR's internally developed rubrics to assess the quality of programme activities, including teacher network meetings, training institutes, midterm reflection and planning meetings, and district alignment meetings. The structure of the rubrics meant that they lacked progress descriptions for each performance indicator, and that some of the descriptions provided were subjective. These limitations reduced the accuracy of ratings and limited enumerator inter-rater reliability. Many of the activities evaluated with the tools received high scores in Year 1; it is important to investigate whether these scores persist after fine-tuning the rubrics and retraining enumerators to use them.

Going forward, it is strongly recommended that all quality rubrics be redesigned so that they have clear scaffolding across scoring criteria and that each scoring criteria is descriptive and clear. Additionally, enumerators will need to be sufficiently trained on how to use these tools to better ensure inter-rater reliability. We suggest that a group of only 10-20 enumerators are trained to use them, although this limited number of trained enumerators may pose a problem when observing the numerous teacher network meetings. We may decide that the same people trained on using the Quality of Teaching tool also conduct these observations, as both tools include quality judgements that only the most competent enumerators should be assigned to make.

5.5 MEASURING AMPLIFICATION

Understanding how STiR's focus on reigniting intrinsic motivation might amplify the engagement with and outcomes of other technical interventions was part of the reason for the selection of the study's districts. However, in Study Year 1, none of the NGOs active in these districts implemented programmes that STiR could amplify. This is an interesting finding considering the often-held belief that officials and teachers are overwhelmed by programmes to participate in and it is encouraging that STiR has been able to register some shifting behaviours among stakeholders even when other technical interventions aren't in place. Moving forward in Year 2 of the study, the intention is to continue understanding and seeking to measure STiR's amplification, assuming that relevant technical programmes will be underway at that time.

6 CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS



Much has been learned during this first evaluation round about how STiR's approach, which is focused on strengthening intrinsic motivation, contributes to sustained improvements in the foundations of lifelong learning among education officials, teachers, and students.

The evaluation has shown that driving impact through intrinsic motivation is a process. Teachers and education officials expressed positivity towards the STiR programme and reported high levels of self-reported motivation and professional gain from their involvement. These self-reported indicators are an important measure of personal opinions on motivation, and they show successful results at this stage of the journey. However, motivation must also be measured using externally verifiable behaviours and proxy measures, such as attendance and commitment to completing daily roles and programme activities. Currently, these measures show that motivational drive still needs to be improved across the education system for the intervention to be successful in embedding and sustaining motivation in stakeholders by the end of the five-year support cycle.

The evaluation also found that the concepts of mentoring, role modelling and trying out new practices are beginning to happen with some regularity – key to this year's focus of helping key stakeholders establish routines. But, the evaluation found that these practices currently often lack substance and depth. Additional efforts are needed to ensure that stakeholders are critically engaging with in these processes and practices through deeper reflection on practice and driving school and system improvements in order to drive lifelong learning.

Overall, the findings from Year 1 of the study demonstrated that STiR's programme met its targets as outlined for Year 2 of the progress pathway. All findings showed that stakeholders within the education system have established routines within each of the foundations of lifelong learning, the overarching achievement expected by the end of Year 2. The evaluation also primarily corroborated monitoring data collected internally by STiR.

Now that routines among stakeholders have been established, STiR must strive to ensure that Year 3 of the programme continues well along the progress pathway and strengthens a culture of improvement among all stakeholders. Key areas to watch include ensuring that teachers are both routinely and effectively implementing teaching strategies in their classrooms, and that feedback mechanisms between teachers, head teachers and education officials improve and progress from mainly positive praise to more constructive feedback for professional development. STiR should focus on helping stakeholders to create a feedback process and role modelling approach that combines content knowledge with an effective, repeated cycle for effective mentoring, observation and coaching. STiR can also do more to ensure that teacher network meetings are occurring as frequently as planned, and that they have the substance required to create a culture of performance and growth in schools. More support will ensure that teachers have adequate opportunities to learn, solve problems and improve together.



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